Healing Plates

THE 30-DAY ALLERGY-FREE FAMILY MEAL PLAN

Breakfast, lunch & dinner free from gluten, dairy, corn, egg, caffeine, tuna & processed sugar



90 family meals

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free | Processed sugar-free

Finally... food the whole family can eat.

BY

Tris Eliverson

WELCOME

You are not alone



Dear Mama, dear Papa,

If you are holding this book, I already know a little of your story - because it is my story too. **I am an autism mum.** I know the child who eats only three foods. The nights that don't end. The family members who say “just give them bread, they'll be fine.” The quiet ache when the words haven't come yet.

When I changed what went on my child's plate - taking out gluten, dairy, corn, eggs and processed sugar, cooking real food from scratch, and adding a gentle detox drink each day - things began to change. Slowly at first. Then I saw a **real, significant improvement** in my child. I could not keep these recipes to myself.

This book holds the meals, drinks and routines that helped my family. No long science. No fancy ingredients you can't find. Just real food from our homes - yam, plantain, okro, rice and beans - made safe, one day at a time.

Every child is different, and food is not a replacement for your doctor. But it is a beautiful place to start - and you don't have to start alone.

You don't have to be perfect. You just have to begin. ♥

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

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START HERE

How to use this book

This book is made to be easy. No long science, no fancy equipment - just real food, one day at a time.

1. **Read the short chapters first**
They explain *why* we cook this way — gut health, foods to enjoy, foods to leave out, and simple daily habits.

2. **Make the Kitchen Basics on a Sunday**
Seasoning mix, bread, flatbread and granola. They are used all month and save you hours.

3. **Shop once a week**
Each week starts with a tick-box shopping list. Cross off what you already have.

4. **Follow the day pages**
Every day has breakfast, lunch and dinner. Swap days around freely - just keep the foods safe.

5. **Go gently**
Change is hard for children who love sameness. Keep one “safe” food on every plate and offer new foods next to it. No pressure, no battles.

Every recipe in this book is free from

Gluten · Dairy · Corn · Egg · Caffeine · Tuna · Pork · Processed sugar - and baked, boiled or steamed instead of deep-fried. Recipes serve a family of 4 (2 adults, 2 children).

This book shares food and lifestyle ideas from one mother's experience. It is not medical advice and does not replace your doctor, dietitian or therapist. Always check with your child's doctor before making big diet changes or giving herbs or supplements, especially if your child takes medication.

PART 1

Understanding healing food

Short, simple chapters on why we cook this way - from the author's own notes and experience.

KNOW BEFORE YOU SHOP

Where allergens hide

Many “safe-looking” foods hide gluten, dairy, corn, caffeine or processed sugar. Here is where they hide - especially in our African kitchens.

Avoid	Where it hides
Gluten	Bread, semovita, wheat swallow, chin chin, puff-puff, meat pie, pasta, **Milo, Bournvita & Ovaltine** (barley malt), soy sauce, many stock cubes
Dairy	Peak/Three Crowns milk, butter, cheese, yogurt, ice cream, whey, casein, “non-dairy” creamers that contain casein
Corn	**Pap/ogi/akamu**, kenkey, banku, tuwo masara, ugali, pap (SA), custard powder, cornflour, popcorn, **baking powder** (corn starch), glucose syrup, xanthan gum, many gluten-free flour blends
Egg	Cakes, mayonnaise, some pasta, egg rolls, meat pies, many “gluten-free” breads and pancake mixes
Caffeine	Tea (black & green), coffee, matcha, cola, energy drinks, **kola nut**, chocolate & cocoa, Milo
Tuna	Canned tuna, tuna salad, some sandwiches, sushi and fish pies
Processed sugar	White & brown sugar, glucose & corn syrup, fizzy drinks, sweetened juice drinks, biscuits, sweets, breakfast cereals, ketchup, flavoured yogurt, Milo
Pork	Bacon, ham, sausages, lard, gelatine (sweets & jelly), some suya

The 10-second label rule

Turn the pack over. Read the ingredients **every time** - brands change their recipes. If you can't pronounce it, or it says “may contain”, leave it on the shelf.

5 steps to healing the gut

When the gut is out of balance, everything feels harder - sleep, moods, toilet troubles and picky eating. These 5 steps are the heart of this book.

1

Remove the irritants

Dairy, gluten, fried food, cookies, bread, processed food, processed sugar, corn and pap. **Swap:** dairy → coconut; flour → tapioca, potato or buckwheat flour.

2

Support digestion with healing nutrients

Zinc and magnesium from leafy vegetables and pumpkin seeds.

3

Repair the gut

Keep the gut hydrated and nourished: berries, psyllium husk, okro stew, egusi soup (no tripe or intestine).

4

Knock down the bad bugs

Garlic, onions, rosemary, thyme, potatoes, carrots, courgette, pumpkin, coconut yogurt, green banana and gluten-free oats.

5

Rebuild & protect — keep the good going

Feed the good bacteria every day: green banana, plantain, onions, garlic, beans and gluten-free oats, plus a spoon of coconut yogurt. Eat at regular times, drink water, sleep well and keep moving. Bring foods back **one at a time**, and keep a simple food & mood diary so you can see what helps. Ask your doctor whether a probiotic is right for your child.

Picky eating is not bad behaviour

A child who eats only three foods is often a child whose nervous system feels unsafe. Go gently. One new food at a time, next to a food they already love.

BUILD EVERY PLATE

Foods to enjoy

Healing food is not about what we take away - it's about what we add. Build every plate around these.

1. Root vegetables first

Squash, sweet potato, pumpkin and yam are the best carbs for our children. They are packed with plant nutrients, give slow natural sugars and fibre, and support the body's natural cleansing.

2. Green leafy vegetables

Ugu, efo, kale, spinach and sukuma are full of anti-inflammatory goodness and help keep the body's elimination pathways open. **Broccoli sprouts are top of the list.**

3. Wild blueberries & mangoes

All fruits are great, but these two are the author's favourites — rich in antioxidants that support the brain and the body under stress.

4. Coriander & parsley

Traditional cleansing herbs. Add them generously to soups, stews and smoothies — and always season fish with coriander.

The cooking oil scorecard

The author's ranking of the healthiest oils to cook with (out of 10). Use these instead of vegetable oil blends.



WHAT WE LEAVE OUT

Foods & things to avoid

Here is what we leave out of every recipe in this book — and why.

We leave out	Why
Gluten	Many children with autism and gut trouble feel better without it. It can irritate a sensitive gut.
Dairy	High in fat and sugar. Lactose is hard to digest for many children, and the milk protein can inflame the gut.
Corn	A common hidden allergen — in pap, custard, baking powder, syrups and most “gluten-free” products.
Eggs	One of the most common food allergens in children. In the author's experience, removing them made a real difference.
Processed sugar & junk	Cookies, cakes and sweets mix fat and sugar, feed unhelpful gut bugs and cause energy spikes and crashes.
Caffeine	Tea, coffee, matcha, chocolate and energy drinks push up the stress hormone cortisol and disturb sleep.
Pork	High in fat, and processed pork (bacon, ham, sausages) contains nitrates.
Tuna & trout	Big fish high up the food chain collect more mercury. We choose small fish — and season them with coriander.

Clean home checklist

- ✓ Swap foil for parchment paper - foil can leach aluminium into food.
- ✓ Replace scratched non-stick pans with stainless steel, cast iron or ceramic.
- ✓ Wash fruit and vegetables well to reduce pesticides.
- ✓ Check make-up, deodorant and skin creams - some contain heavy metals.
- ✓ Choose fragrance-free, simple products for your child.
- ✓ Cook from scratch and cut down on over-processed food.

EVERY DAY

Healing habits

Food is only part of healing. These small daily habits from the author's own routine make a big difference.

Better sleep

- Lemon balm tea about 2 hours before bed — the author's favourite sleep herb.
- Same bedtime every night, dim lights, no screens for the last hour.

Easy bowels

- Plenty of water every day.
- Add seeds: chia, flax, pumpkin, sunflower, psyllium husk.
- Fruits: celery, cucumber, mango, blueberry, watermelon.

Move every day

- Bouncing on a trampoline gets the lymphatic system moving.
- Dancing, jumping and outdoor play all count.

Detox slowly

- Go gently. Too much, too fast can make children feel worse.
- See the Healing Sips bonus book for one gentle drink a day.

Energy & recovery

Every cell has tiny “batteries” called mitochondria. When they are drained - by a heavy load on the body, missing nutrients, stress or toxins - children can struggle more.

Signs of low energy reserves

- Poor sleep
- Bad reactions when detox is tried
- Going backwards after an illness
- Speech delay
- Tiredness

Recharge the batteries

- **Get out in the sun** every morning.
- **Keep them moving** - the trampoline is perfect.
- **Protect sleep** like gold.
- Eat colourful, nutrient-rich food every day.

FROM THE AUTHOR'S JOURNEY

Food steps that may support speech

These are the food steps the author took while supporting her own child's speech. Every child is different — but many parents find a calmer gut helps everything else.

1 **Change the plate**

Move towards more plant-based meals. Cut gluten, dairy, processed food and processed sugar.

2 **Add brain-friendly vegetables**

Squash, leafy greens, kale, cabbage and **broccoli sprouts** — rich in sulforaphane.

3 **Smart swaps**

Lentil pasta instead of wheat pasta. Buckwheat flour for bread.

4 **Gentle support**

I used **lion's mane and spirulina**, and found them helpful once my child began to talk. For gut troubles, **sea moss with black seed oil** (½ tsp, 3 times a week, age 3+).

Food is a support, not a cure. Keep going with speech therapy, and always ask your child's doctor before starting any herb or supplement.

NATURAL SUPPORT

Herbs by symptom

Herbs many parents use alongside a healing diet. This is my personal guide.

Symptom	Herbs parents commonly use
Stimming (vocal, hand flapping, rocking)	Lion's mane, brahmi, ashwagandha
Sensory-seeking behaviour	Lion's mane, brahmi
Sleep	Lemon balm, ashwagandha, lion's mane
Hyperactivity	Lemon balm, ashwagandha
Picky eating	Sea moss, lion's mane
Constipation / diarrhoea	Black seed oil, sea moss, milk thistle
Vomiting / reflux	Brahmi, ashwagandha, sea moss
Frequent infections	Astragalus, black seed oil, sea moss
Eczema	Sea moss, black seed oil
Mould detox	Astragalus, spirulina, black seed oil, sea moss

Safety first — please read

- Talk to your child's doctor before giving any herb, especially if they take medication.
- Many herbs (like ashwagandha, licorice and milk thistle) are not well studied in young children.
- Sea moss is rich in iodine - check first if there is any thyroid condition.
- Start one herb at a time, with a small amount, and watch closely.

TALK TO YOUR DOCTOR

Tests worth asking about

If your child shows some of these signs, these are tests you can ask your doctor about.

Test	Signs that make it worth asking
Ferritin & full blood count	Tiredness, pale skin, clumsiness, developmental delay, frequent infections, picky eating, unexplained behaviour changes
Iron studies	Hyperactivity, poor sleep, emotional ups and downs, restlessness, headaches, restricted diet
Vitamin B12	Speech delay, clumsiness, developmental plateau, vegetarian or low-meat diet, gut problems
Thyroid (TSH ± free T4)	Hyperactivity or very low energy, mood swings, constipation, growth worries, family history, speech delay
Coeliac screen (tTG-IgA + total IgA)	Bloating, changing stools, low iron, behaviour worse after meals, family autoimmune history, slow growth
CRP (± ESR)	Ongoing tummy pain or gut problems, unexplained tiredness, poor growth, chronic diarrhoea
Vitamin D	Little time outdoors, autoimmune family history, low mood
Liver function & albumin	Gut problems, poor absorption, tiredness, regular medication, growth worries
Metabolic panel	Tiredness, great thirst, past jaundice, frequent weeing, sleep issues, energy spikes and crashes
Zinc & copper	Often not offered as standard — may need a private lab
Fasting glucose & insulin	Huge appetite, sleep problems, strong reaction to carbohydrates

Your doctor will decide which tests are right for your child. Take this page to your appointment.

PART 2

The 30-day plan

Kitchen basics, your month at a glance, weekly shopping lists and 90 family meals.

MAKE ONCE, USE ALL MONTH

Kitchen basics

BASIC Flax "Egg" (replaces 1 egg)

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 tbsp ground flaxseed
- [ ] 3 tbsp water

STEPS

1. Stir the flaxseed and water together.
2. Leave for 5 minutes until thick, like egg white.
3. Use in pancakes, muffins and meatballs in place of 1 egg.

Why it helps: Binds food just like egg, and adds fibre and omega-3.

BASIC Healing Seasoning Mix (replaces stock cubes)

15 min + 4–6 hrs drying

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup cooked chicken breast or lean beef, shredded (no skin, no fat)
- [ ] 2 tbsp onion powder, 1 tbsp garlic powder
- [ ] 1 tbsp dried thyme, 1 tsp ground ginger
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground crayfish (optional)
- [ ] 1 tsp white pepper, 1 tsp pure curry powder
- [ ] 1 tbsp sea salt

STEPS

1. Spread the cooked meat thinly on a parchment-lined tray.
2. Dry in the oven on its lowest setting (70–80 °C / 160–175 °F), door slightly open, for 4–6 hrs until completely dry and crumbly.
3. Cool, then blend to a fine powder.
4. Add all the spices and blend again until even.
5. Store in an airtight jar in the fridge for up to 1 month, or freeze for 3 months. Use 1–2 tsp wherever a recipe says "seasoning".

Why it helps: Real chicken or beef flavour like a stock cube — without the hidden wheat, corn starch, MSG or sugar.

Good idea: Make a chicken jar and a beef jar. Chicken for soups and rice, beef for stews and egusi.

BASIC Soft Cassava Flatbread (wraps, pizza & pinwheels)

20 min · makes 6

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup (130 g) cassava flour
- [ ] ¾ cup warm water
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] ½ tsp salt

STEPS

1. Mix everything into a soft dough. Rest 5 min.
2. Divide into 6 balls (or 2 for pizza bases).
3. Press thin between two sheets of parchment paper.
4. Cook in a dry hot pan 1–2 min each side until spotty.
5. Stack under a clean towel to stay soft.

Why it helps: A gluten-free, corn-free, egg-free wrap you can trust.

BASIC

Easy Buckwheat Bread (no yeast, no egg)

1 hr 10 min · 1 loaf

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups (240 g) buckwheat flour
- [ ] ½ cup (60 g) tapioca flour
- [ ] 2 tbsp psyllium husk powder
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda, 1 tsp salt
- [ ] 1½ cups warm water
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a loaf tin with parchment.
2. Whisk the dry ingredients together.
3. Add water, oil and vinegar. Mix to a thick, sticky dough. Rest 5 min.
4. Smooth into the tin with wet hands. Bake 55–60 min.
5. Cool completely before slicing — it firms up as it cools.

Why it helps: Buckwheat bread is on the author's speech-support list. Psyllium holds it together instead of egg.

Time saver: Slice, then freeze. Toast straight from the freezer.

BASIC

Crunchy Nut-Free Granola

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] ½ cup pumpkin seeds
- [ ] ½ cup sunflower seeds
- [ ] ¼ cup coconut flakes
- [ ] 3 tbsp melted coconut oil
- [ ] 3 tbsp maple syrup or honey
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 160 °C / 320 °F. Line a tray with parchment.
2. Mix everything and spread thin.
3. Bake 20 min, stirring halfway.
4. Cool completely — it crisps as it cools. Store in a jar.

Why it helps: Seeds give zinc and magnesium — step 2 of healing the gut.

YOUR MONTH AT A GLANCE

30 days of family meals

1 B Banana buckwheat pancakes L Okro soup & pounded yam D Mama's pasta & meat sauce	**2** B Yam & ugu sauce L Chicken burrito bowl D Coriander pepper fish	**3** B Mango overnight oats L Jollof rice & chicken D Chicken nuggets & wedges	**4** B Millet porridge L Butternut mac & cheese D Egusi soup & amala	**5** B Sweet potato hash L Thai coconut noodle soup D Egg-free moi moi	**6** B Ripe plantain pancakes L Kenyan beef pilau D Family pizza night	**7** B Coconut yogurt parfait L Sunday roast chicken D Mama's chicken & potato soup
8 B Banana oat muffins L Efo riro & pounded yam D Fish fingers & mash	**9** B Yam porridge (asaro) L Chicken fried rice D Coconut chicken curry	**10** B Avocado toast L Red red & dodo D Turkey burgers	**11** B Coconut quinoa porridge L Hidden-veg tomato soup D Ofada & green stew	**12** B Green smoothie bowl L Chicken shawarma bowl D Vegetable soup & yam	**13** B Sweet potato pancakes L Ghana light soup D Beef kebab skewers	**14** B Fonio porridge L Shepherd's pie D Beef & pumpkin soup
15 B Buckwheat crêpes L Ogbono soup & amala D Creamy chicken pasta	**16** B Plantain & garden egg L Lentil sweet potato soup D Chicken suya & yam fries	**17** B Mango chia pudding L Coconut rice & fish D Mini meatball pasta	**18** B Akara bites & millet pap L Beef stir-fry noodles D Sukuma & millet ugali	**19** B Banana-carob oats L Chakalaka & rice D Baked salmon tray	**20** B Apple buckwheat porridge L Waakye & fish stew D Fish & chips	**21** B Sunday breakfast plate L Matoke & beef D Chicken & rice soup
22 B Beans & plantain porridge L Caesar lettuce wraps D Banga soup & rice	**23** B Tropical granola bowl L Jollof spaghetti D Honey-garlic chicken	**24** B Millet & tiger nut milk L Chicken fajitas D Fish pepper soup	**25** B Green smoothie & toast L Beef stew & rice D Stuffed peppers	**26** B Breakfast burritos L Ofe nsala D Fish tacos	**27** B Yam & sardine sauce L Coconut bean stew D Pizza night	**28** B Coconut rice porridge L Roast turkey & gravy D Green plantain porridge
29 B Apple rice pudding L Kontomire & plantain D Chicken noodle soup	**30** B Plantain pancake stack L Party jollof plate D Taco bar					

WEEK 1 · TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 1 shopping list

Everything for Days 1–7. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Ugu or spinach — 4 big bunches
- [ ] Okro — 15
- [ ] Tomatoes — 16
- [ ] Red peppers — 6
- [ ] Scotch bonnet / ata rodo — 5
- [ ] Onions — 10, red onion — 1
- [ ] Garlic — 2 bulbs, ginger — 1 large piece
- [ ] Carrots — 10
- [ ] Courgette — 1
- [ ] Butternut squash — 1
- [ ] Broccoli — 2 heads
- [ ] Sweet potatoes — 8
- [ ] Irish potatoes — 2 kg
- [ ] Cucumber — 3
- [ ] Mushrooms — 200 g
- [ ] Lemongrass — 1 stalk
- [ ] Avocados — 5
- [ ] Frozen peas — 1 bag

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Yam — 1 medium
- [ ] Green plantains — 3
- [ ] Very ripe plantains — 2
- [ ] Ripe bananas — 2
- [ ] Mangoes — 2
- [ ] Mixed berries — 3 punnets
- [ ] Lemons — 3, limes — 4

Protein

- [ ] Chicken pieces — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Chicken thighs — 1.1 kg
- [ ] Chicken breast — 1.1 kg
- [ ] Whole chicken — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Beef mince — 750 g
- [ ] Beef cubes — 1.1 kg
- [ ] Turkey mince — 250 g
- [ ] Mackerel or tilapia — 4 small
- [ ] Black-eyed beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Black beans — 1 tin

Grains & flours

- [ ] Rice or gluten-free pasta — 400 g
- [ ] Lentil pasta — 400 g
- [ ] Long-grain rice + basmati — 3 cups each
- [ ] Rice noodles — 200 g
- [ ] Buckwheat flour
- [ ] Cassava flour
- [ ] Pure millet flour
- [ ] Certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] Amala & pounded yam flour
- [ ] Ground egusi — 1 cup

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 5 tins
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 1 large tub
- [ ] Dairy-free cheese — 1 pack
- [ ] Chopped tomatoes — 2 tins, passata — 1 jar, tomato paste
- [ ] Red palm, olive, avocado & coconut oil
- [ ] Chia seeds, ground flaxseed
- [ ] Pumpkin & sunflower seeds, coconut flakes
- [ ] Coconut aminos
- [ ] Maple syrup or raw honey, dates
- [ ] Baking soda, tapioca flour
- [ ] Psyllium husk powder, apple cider vinegar

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Fresh coriander — 2 bunches
- [ ] Fresh rosemary & thyme
- [ ] Dried thyme, oregano, basil, bay leaves
- [ ] Pure curry powder, paprika, cumin, turmeric
- [ ] Cinnamon, cloves, cardamom, black pepper
- [ ] Garlic & onion powder, ground ginger
- [ ] Ground crayfish
- [ ] Sea salt

WEEK 1

Day 1

"Small changes, one plate at a time. You are doing better than you think."

BREAKFAST Fluffy Banana Buckwheat Pancakes

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup buckwheat flour
- [ ] 1 ripe banana, mashed
- [ ] 1 flax egg (see Basics)
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda + 1 tsp lemon juice
- [ ] ½ tsp cinnamon, pinch of salt
- [ ] Coconut oil, for the pan

STEPS

1. Mix the banana, flax egg and coconut milk.
2. Stir in the flour, cinnamon, salt and baking soda, then the lemon juice.
3. Heat a little oil in a pan on medium-low.
4. Cook small pancakes 2 min until bubbles appear, flip, 1 more min.
5. Top with berries and a drizzle of maple syrup.

Why it helps: Buckwheat is naturally gluten-free and full of magnesium.

Good to know: Baking soda + lemon makes pancakes rise without corn-starch baking powder.

LUNCH Okro Soup with Chicken & Pounded Yam

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken pieces
- [ ] 15 fresh okro, chopped
- [ ] 1 cup ugu or spinach
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 ata rodo peppers
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground crayfish
- [ ] 2 tbsp red palm oil, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Pounded yam or amala, to serve

STEPS

1. Season chicken with onion and seasoning. Cook in 2 cups water for 20 min.
2. Add palm oil, pepper and crayfish. Cook 5 min.
3. Add okro and cook only 3–4 min so it stays green.
4. Stir in the greens and turn off the heat.
5. Serve with pounded yam.

Why it helps: Okro is soft and gentle on the gut and helps keep things moving.

Kid tip: Picky eater? Blend the okro smooth so there are no "slimy bits" to see.

DINNER Mama's Pasta with Meat & Tomato Sauce

Author's family favourite
40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g rice pasta or gluten-free pasta (or lentil pasta)
- [ ] 500 g beef mince
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 carrot, finely grated (hidden veg)
- [ ] 2 tins chopped tomatoes or 6 fresh tomatoes, blended
- [ ] 1 tsp dried thyme or oregano, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 tbsp olive oil, salt

STEPS

1. Soften onion and garlic in olive oil, 3 min.
2. Add the mince and brown it, breaking it up.
3. Stir in the carrot, tomatoes and herbs. Simmer 20 min.
4. Cook the pasta as the pack says. Drain.
5. Toss the pasta through the sauce and serve.

Why it helps: A dinner my child asks for again and again — simple, filling and completely safe.

Kid tip: Blend the sauce smooth if your child doesn't like to see "bits".

WEEK 1

Day 2

Today's habit: 10 minutes of bouncing or dancing — it gets the lymph system moving.

BREAKFAST Boiled Yam with Ugu & Tomato Sauce

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ medium yam, peeled & sliced
- [ ] 2 cups ugu (or spinach), chopped
- [ ] 3 fresh tomatoes, chopped
- [ ] 1 onion, sliced
- [ ] 2 tbsp unrefined red palm oil
- [ ] ¼ tsp ground crayfish (optional)
- [ ] Pinch of salt

STEPS

1. Boil the yam in salted water for 15–20 min until soft.
2. Warm the palm oil gently — don't let it smoke. Add onion, cook 2 min.
3. Add tomatoes and crayfish. Cook 5 min.
4. Stir in the ugu, cook 2 min, then turn off the heat.
5. Spoon the sauce over the yam.

Why it helps: Yam gives slow, steady energy. Ugu is rich in iron and magnesium.

Swap it: No yam? Use sweet potato. No ugu? Use spinach, kale or sukuma wiki.

LUNCH Chicken Burrito Bowl

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups rice
- [ ] 600 g chicken thighs
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin & paprika, ½ tsp garlic powder
- [ ] 1 tin black beans, rinsed
- [ ] 2 avocados, sliced
- [ ] 3 tomatoes + ½ red onion + coriander (salsa)
- [ ] 2 limes, olive oil, salt

STEPS

1. Cook the rice.
2. Rub chicken with the spices, oil and salt. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 25 min, then slice.
3. Warm the beans with a pinch of salt.
4. Chop tomatoes, onion and coriander with lime juice for salsa.
5. Build bowls: rice, beans, chicken, avocado, salsa.

Why it helps: Beans and avocado bring fibre and healthy fats that keep little tummies full.

Allergy note: Shop-bought bowls usually add corn — this one leaves it out.

DINNER Coriander Pepper Fish & Green Plantain

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 small mackerel (titus) or tilapia
- [ ] 3 green (unripe) plantains
- [ ] 1 handful fresh coriander
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, 1 small onion
- [ ] 1 scotch bonnet (skip for kids)
- [ ] 1 tbsp olive oil, juice of 1 lemon, salt

STEPS

1. Blend coriander, garlic, onion, pepper, oil, lemon and salt to a paste.
2. Rub the paste over the fish. Rest 15 min.
3. Bake on parchment at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20–25 min (no foil).
4. Meanwhile, peel and boil the plantains for 20 min.
5. Serve with sliced cucumber.

Why it helps: Small fish carry far less mercury than tuna. Coriander is a traditional cleansing herb.

WEEK 1

Day 3

"Healing is not a straight line. Celebrate every small win."

BREAKFAST Mango Chia Overnight Oats

5 min + overnight

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 2 tbsp chia seeds
- [ ] 1 mango, diced
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp maple syrup (optional)

STEPS

1. Stir oats, coconut milk, chia, cinnamon and maple together.
2. Spoon into 4 jars or cups.
3. Cover and chill overnight.
4. In the morning, top with mango and eat cold.

Why it helps: Chia and oats are gentle fibre for regular, easy bowels.

Swap it: Can't have oats? Use millet or buckwheat flakes instead.

LUNCH Jollof Rice with Baked Chicken

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups long-grain parboiled rice
- [ ] 1 kg chicken pieces
- [ ] 6 tomatoes, 3 red peppers, 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato paste, 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp pure curry powder, 2 bay leaves
- [ ] 2 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 3 cups chicken stock or water

STEPS

1. Season chicken and bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 40 min.
2. Blend tomatoes, peppers, onion and scotch bonnet.
3. Fry tomato paste in oil 3 min, add the blend and cook 15 min until thick.
4. Add spices, stock and rinsed rice. Cover tightly and cook on low 25–30 min.
5. Fluff and serve with the chicken and a fresh salad.

Why it helps: A home favourite made without stock cubes — all flavour, no hidden wheat or MSG.

DINNER Crispy Baked Chicken Nuggets & Sweet Potato Wedges

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g chicken breast, cut into bite pieces
- [ ] 1 cup cassava flour
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp garlic powder, salt
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 3 sweet potatoes, cut into wedges
- [ ] Frozen peas, to serve

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F. Line 2 trays with parchment.
2. Toss the wedges with 1 tbsp oil and salt. Bake 30 min.
3. Toss chicken in the remaining oil, then roll in flour mixed with the spices.
4. Bake the nuggets 15–18 min, turning once, until golden.
5. Serve with peas and Sunshine Ketchup (Lunch Box book).

Why it helps: All the fun of fast food — with no egg, no wheat crumb and no deep frying.

Picky eater trick: Let them dip! Children try more food when they can dip it.

WEEK 1

Day 4

Today's habit: eat breakfast near a sunny window or outside — morning light helps sleep later.

BREAKFAST Creamy Millet Porridge (Hausa Koko Style)

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup pure millet flour (no corn added)
- [ ] 4 cups water
- [ ] 1 thumb ginger, grated
- [ ] Pinch of cloves
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 3 dates, chopped (to sweeten)

STEPS

1. Mix the millet flour with 1 cup cold water until smooth.
2. Boil the rest of the water with ginger, cloves and dates.
3. Pour in the millet mix, stirring all the time.
4. Cook 8–10 min on low until thick. Stir in coconut milk.

Why it helps: Millet is a gluten-free ancient grain that is gentle on the stomach.

Allergy note: Many "koko" and "uji" mixes contain maize — buy pure millet flour.

LUNCH Creamy Butternut "Mac & Cheese"

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g lentil or chickpea pasta
- [ ] 3 cups butternut squash, cubed
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 3 tbsp nutritional yeast (optional — cheesy taste)
- [ ] 1 garlic clove, ½ tsp turmeric, salt
- [ ] 1 cup small broccoli florets

STEPS

1. Boil the squash and garlic 12 min until soft. Drain.
2. Blend with coconut milk, nutritional yeast, turmeric and salt.
3. Cook the pasta, adding the broccoli for the last 3 minutes.
4. Stir the golden sauce through the pasta.

Why it helps: Squash is a root-vegetable carb from the author's "foods to eat" list — and kids love the colour.

Leftover magic: Bake leftovers in a muffin tin for 15 min to make mac bites for lunch boxes.

DINNER Egusi Soup with Beef & Amala

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup ground egusi
- [ ] 500 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion + 2 red peppers + 1 scotch bonnet, blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground crayfish
- [ ] 2 cups ugu or spinach
- [ ] Amala (yam flour), to serve

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning mix until tender, 30 min. Keep the stock.
2. Mix egusi with a little water to a thick paste.
3. Warm palm oil, add the pepper blend and cook 5 min. Add egusi in lumps and cook 10 min.
4. Add beef, stock and crayfish. Simmer 10 min.
5. Stir in the greens. Serve with amala.

Why it helps: Egusi (melon seeds) is a gut-repairing food from step 3 — rich in protein and zinc.

WEEK 1

Day 5

"You are not behind. You are exactly where your family needs you to be."

BREAKFAST — Sweet Potato & Spinach Breakfast Hash

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 sweet potatoes, diced small
- [ ] 1 red pepper, 1 onion, diced
- [ ] 250 g turkey mince (or 1 tin beans)
- [ ] 2 handfuls spinach
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, salt
- [ ] 2 tbsp avocado oil
- [ ] 1 avocado, to serve

STEPS

1. Cook sweet potato in oil, covered, 10 min, stirring now and then.
2. Add onion, pepper and turkey. Cook 8 min.
3. Add paprika, salt and spinach. Stir until wilted.
4. Serve topped with sliced avocado.

Why it helps: A savoury, protein-rich breakfast that keeps energy steady until lunch.

LUNCH — Thai Coconut Chicken Noodle Soup

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken thighs, thinly sliced
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 3 cups stock
- [ ] 1 stalk lemongrass, bashed
- [ ] 1 thumb ginger, 2 garlic cloves, sliced
- [ ] 1 tbsp coconut aminos (instead of soy sauce)
- [ ] 200 g rice noodles
- [ ] Lime, fresh coriander

STEPS

1. Simmer stock, lemongrass, ginger and garlic 5 min.
2. Add chicken and cook 8 min.
3. Pour in coconut milk and coconut aminos. Heat gently.
4. Cook the noodles, divide into bowls and ladle soup over.
5. Finish with lime and coriander.

Why it helps: Warm, mild and soothing — garlic and ginger support step 4 of healing the gut.

Allergy note: Soy sauce contains wheat. Coconut aminos tastes similar and is safe.

DINNER — Egg-Free Moi Moi with Avocado Salad

1 hr 15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups black-eyed beans, soaked & peeled
- [ ] 1 red pepper, 1 scotch bonnet, 1 onion
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] About 1 cup warm water
- [ ] Avocado, tomato & cucumber salad

STEPS

1. Blend beans, pepper and onion with water until very smooth.
2. Stir in oil, crayfish, seasoning and salt.
3. Pour into greased ramekins or silicone cups (no foil).
4. Steam 45–50 min until firm.
5. Serve with the salad.

Why it helps: Beans set perfectly on their own — no egg needed. Packed with plant protein.

WEEK 1

Day 6

It's Friday — Sweet Treat Day! See the sweet treats page.

BREAKFAST Ripe Plantain Pancakes

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 very ripe (black) plantains
- [ ] ½ cup cassava flour
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] ½ cup coconut milk
- [ ] ½ tsp cinnamon, pinch salt
- [ ] ½ tsp baking soda + squeeze of lemon
- [ ] Coconut oil, for the pan

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Heat a little oil in a pan on medium-low.
3. Cook small pancakes 2–3 min each side.
4. Serve with berries or coconut yogurt.

Why it helps: Naturally sweet from the plantain — no sugar needed.

LUNCH Kenyan Beef Pilau & Kachumbari

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups basmati rice
- [ ] 600 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 2 onions, 4 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 2 potatoes, cubed
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin, cinnamon, cardamom, black pepper; 4 cloves
- [ ] 2 tomatoes, salt
- [ ] Kachumbari: tomato, red onion, cucumber, coriander, lime

STEPS

1. Boil beef with salt until tender, 30 min. Keep 5 cups of stock.
2. Brown onions in oil, add garlic, ginger and spices, 2 min.
3. Add beef, potatoes, tomatoes and rinsed rice; stir.
4. Pour in stock, cover and cook on low 20 min.
5. Serve with the fresh chopped kachumbari.

Why it helps: Warm spices like cinnamon and ginger are gentle on digestion.

DINNER Family Pizza Night

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cassava flatbread pizza bases (see Basics)
- [ ] 1 cup tomato passata
- [ ] 1 tsp oregano
- [ ] 1 cup dairy-free cheese, grated
- [ ] Cooked chicken, peppers, mushrooms
- [ ] Olive oil

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F.
2. Spread passata over the bases, sprinkle oregano.
3. Add cheese and toppings.
4. Bake 10–12 min until bubbling.
5. Slice and serve with a green salad.

Why it helps: Pizza night is back on the menu — no gluten, dairy or corn.

Picky eater trick: Let each child top their own slice. Kids eat what they make.

WEEK 1

Day 7

Sunday: batch-cook day. See next week's plan and prep ahead.

BREAKFAST Coconut Yogurt Berry Parfait

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups coconut yogurt
- [ ] 2 cups mixed berries
- [ ] 1 cup Crunchy Nut-Free Granola (see Basics)
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey or maple syrup (optional)

STEPS

1. Layer yogurt, berries and granola in glasses.
2. Repeat the layers.
3. Drizzle with honey and eat straight away.

Why it helps: Coconut yogurt feeds good gut bacteria — step 4 of healing the gut.

LUNCH Sunday Roast Chicken & Vegetables

1 hr 30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 whole chicken (1.5 kg)
- [ ] 1 kg potatoes, halved
- [ ] 4 carrots, 2 sweet potatoes
- [ ] 1 lemon, 1 garlic bulb
- [ ] Fresh rosemary & thyme
- [ ] 3 tbsp avocado oil, salt
- [ ] 1 tbsp tapioca flour (for gravy)

STEPS

1. Rub chicken with oil, salt and herbs; put lemon and garlic inside. Roast at 190 °C / 375 °F for 1 hr 20 min.
2. Boil potatoes 8 min, drain, toss in oil and roast 45 min with the carrots.
3. Rest the chicken 10 min.
4. Stir pan juices with tapioca mixed in a little water until thick — gravy!
5. Serve with steamed broccoli.

Why it helps: Rosemary, thyme and garlic are all on the author's gut-friendly list.

Allergy note: Gravy granules often contain wheat and corn starch. Tapioca makes a safe gravy.

DINNER Mama's Chicken, Potato & Carrot Soup

Author's family favourite
45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken (breast or thighs)
- [ ] 4 Irish potatoes, peeled & cubed
- [ ] 4 carrots, sliced
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp dried thyme, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 5 cups water
- [ ] Homemade buckwheat bread, to serve

STEPS

1. Boil the chicken with onion, garlic, thyme and seasoning for 25 min. Lift out and shred.
2. Boil the potatoes and carrots in the same stock for 15 min until soft.
3. Blend the vegetables smooth — or blend half and chop the rest very tiny.
4. Stir the shredded chicken back in. Simmer 5 min.
5. Serve warm with buckwheat bread.

Why it helps: My child's favourite. Blending the vegetables means all the goodness goes in — without them seeing it.

Kid tip: Some days blend it all, some days leave tiny pieces — a gentle way to get used to new textures.

SWEET TREAT

Coconut Mango Ice Pops

No processed sugar
10 min + freezing

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 ripe mangoes, peeled & chopped
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] Juice of ½ lime
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey (optional — not for babies under 1)

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Pour into ice-pop moulds or small cups.
3. Freeze for 6 hours or overnight.
4. Run the mould under warm water for 10 seconds to pop out.

Why it helps: A sweet, cold treat with no dairy, no processed sugar and a big dose of vitamin C.

Sweet moment: Let your child pour the mix into the moulds — helping makes them want to taste.

SWEET TREAT

Banana Blueberry "Nice-Cream"

No processed sugar
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 ripe bananas, sliced and frozen
- [ ] 3 tbsp coconut milk
- [ ] Handful of blueberries
- [ ] Sprinkle of pumpkin seeds (optional)

STEPS

1. Blend the frozen banana and coconut milk until thick and creamy.
2. Add the blueberries and pulse a few times for purple swirls.
3. Scoop into bowls and top with pumpkin seeds. Eat straight away.

Why it helps: Tastes like ice cream, but it's just fruit. Blueberries are rich in antioxidants.

Sweet moment: Freeze sliced bananas every time they get spotty — instant dessert, no waste.

Every Friday is Sweet Treat Day — because healing food should still feel like a celebration.

WEEK 2 · TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 2 shopping list

Everything for Days 8–14. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Spinach / efo / ugu — 8 big bunches
- [ ] Waterleaf — 2 bunches
- [ ] Tomatoes — 20
- [ ] Red peppers — 6, green pepper — 1
- [ ] Green peppers — 6, green scotch bonnet — 2
- [ ] Scotch bonnet — 4
- [ ] Onions — 12
- [ ] Garlic — 2 bulbs, ginger — 1 piece
- [ ] Carrots — 8
- [ ] Courgette — 1
- [ ] Green beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Cabbage — ½, cucumber — 3
- [ ] Lettuce — 1
- [ ] Sweet potatoes — 9
- [ ] Irish potatoes — 3
- [ ] Pumpkin or butternut — 1 small
- [ ] Avocados — 4
- [ ] Frozen peas — 1 bag
- [ ] Garden eggs — 2

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Yam — 1 medium
- [ ] Ripe plantains — 3
- [ ] Bananas — 8
- [ ] Mangoes — 3
- [ ] Blueberries — 1 cup
- [ ] Mixed berries — 1 punnet
- [ ] Lemons — 4, limes — 1

Protein

- [ ] Beef cubes — 1.3 kg
- [ ] Beef steak — 600 g
- [ ] Beef or lamb mince — 500 g
- [ ] Turkey mince — 500 g
- [ ] Chicken thighs — 1.2 kg
- [ ] Chicken breast — 400 g
- [ ] Chicken pieces — 1 kg
- [ ] White fish fillets — 500 g
- [ ] Tilapia or mackerel — 500 g
- [ ] Black-eyed beans — 2 cups

Grains & flours

- [ ] Certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] Quinoa — 1 cup
- [ ] Fonio (acha) — 1 cup
- [ ] Ofada or brown rice — 3 cups
- [ ] Long-grain rice — 6 cups
- [ ] Buckwheat flour
- [ ] Cassava flour
- [ ] Pounded yam flour

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 6 tins
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 1 tub
- [ ] Tomato paste, chopped tomatoes — 2 tins
- [ ] Red palm oil, olive & avocado oil, coconut oil
- [ ] Coconut aminos
- [ ] Ground flaxseed, pumpkin seeds
- [ ] Pure maple syrup, dates
- [ ] Tapioca flour, baking soda
- [ ] Nutritional yeast (optional)

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Fresh coriander, spring onions
- [ ] Iru (optional), crayfish
- [ ] Thyme, basil, bay leaves
- [ ] Curry powder, turmeric, cumin, paprika
- [ ] Cinnamon, garlic powder
- [ ] Healing Seasoning Mix (make Sunday)

WEEK 2

Day 8

Week 2 — you made it through week 1! Notice one good thing that changed.

BREAKFAST Banana Blueberry Oat Muffins

35 min · makes 12

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats, blended to flour
- [ ] 2 ripe bananas, mashed
- [ ] 2 flax eggs
- [ ] ⅓ cup pure maple syrup
- [ ] ¼ cup melted coconut oil
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda + 1 tbsp lemon juice
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 cup blueberries

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a muffin tin with paper cases.
2. Mix banana, flax eggs, maple and oil.
3. Stir in oat flour, cinnamon and baking soda, then the lemon juice.
4. Fold in the blueberries and fill the cases.
5. Bake 20–22 min. Cool before eating.

Why it helps: A grab-and-go breakfast. Freeze half for busy mornings.

Swap it: Can't have oats? Use 2 cups buckwheat flour instead.

LUNCH Efo Riro with Beef & Pounded Yam

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 big bunches spinach or efo tete, chopped
- [ ] 500 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 2 red peppers, 1 scotch bonnet, 1 onion — roughly blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp iru (optional)
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] Pounded yam, to serve

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning until tender, 30 min.
2. Squeeze excess water from the washed greens.
3. Warm palm oil, add the pepper blend and cook 10 min.
4. Add beef, crayfish and iru. Cook 5 min.
5. Stir in greens, cook 3 min. Serve with pounded yam.

Why it helps: Leafy greens help open up the body's natural elimination pathways.

DINNER Crispy Fish Fingers, Sweet Potato Mash & Peas

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g white fish (tilapia, cod or hake), cut into fingers
- [ ] 1 cup cassava flour + ½ cup gluten-free oats, blitzed
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp garlic powder, salt
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 3 sweet potatoes
- [ ] 2 cups frozen peas
- [ ] Lemon wedges

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F. Line a tray with parchment.
2. Brush fish with oil, then press into the seasoned crumb.
3. Bake 12–15 min until golden.
4. Boil sweet potatoes 15 min and mash with a little coconut milk.
5. Serve with peas and lemon.

Why it helps: White fish is low in mercury and gentle — a great first fish for children.

Picky eater trick: Serve with Sunshine Ketchup from the Lunch Box book for dipping.

WEEK 2

Day 9

Today's habit: a glass of water before every meal.

BREAKFAST Yam Porridge (Asaro)

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ medium yam, peeled & cubed
- [ ] 2 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes, 1 red pepper — blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 handful spinach or ugu
- [ ] Salt

STEPS

1. Put yam in a pot with water to just cover. Boil 10 min.
2. Add the pepper blend, palm oil, crayfish and seasoning.
3. Cook 15 min until yam is very soft.
4. Mash some of the yam to thicken. Stir in greens.

Why it helps: Warm, soft and filling — easy for children who prefer smooth textures.

Kid tip: Mash it all smooth for children who don't like lumps.

LUNCH Chicken Fried Rice (no sweetcorn)

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups cooked rice (cold is best)
- [ ] 400 g chicken breast, diced
- [ ] 2 carrots, diced small
- [ ] 1 cup green beans + 1 cup peas
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp curry powder, 1 tsp thyme
- [ ] 2 tbsp coconut aminos, 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] Spring onions, to finish

STEPS

1. Cook chicken in 1 tbsp oil with curry and thyme, 8 min. Set aside.
2. Add remaining oil, onion, garlic and vegetables. Cook 5 min.
3. Add the rice and stir-fry 5 min.
4. Return chicken, add coconut aminos and toss.
5. Finish with spring onions.

Why it helps: All the party flavour with no stock cubes, soy sauce or sweetcorn.

Allergy note: Nigerian fried rice usually has sweetcorn — we leave it out (corn).

DINNER Mild Coconut Chicken & Spinach Curry

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g chicken thighs, diced
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure curry powder, ½ tsp turmeric
- [ ] 2 tomatoes, chopped
- [ ] 2 handfuls spinach
- [ ] Rice, to serve

STEPS

1. Soften onion, garlic and ginger in oil, 3 min.
2. Add curry and turmeric, stir 1 min.
3. Add chicken and tomatoes, cook 5 min.
4. Pour in coconut milk and simmer 15 min.
5. Stir in spinach. Serve with rice.

Why it helps: Turmeric and ginger are warming and gentle on the tummy.

WEEK 2

Day 10

"Progress, not perfection."

BREAKFAST Avocado & Tomato Buckwheat Toast

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 slices Easy Buckwheat Bread (see Basics)
- [ ] 2 ripe avocados
- [ ] 2 tomatoes, sliced
- [ ] Squeeze of lemon, pinch of salt
- [ ] 1 tbsp pumpkin seeds

STEPS

1. Toast the bread.
2. Mash avocado with lemon and salt.
3. Spread on toast and top with tomato and pumpkin seeds.

Why it helps: Healthy fats keep children full and focused through the morning.

LUNCH Ghana Red Red with Baked Dodo

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups black-eyed beans, soaked
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 3 tomatoes, 1 scotch bonnet — blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 3 ripe plantains
- [ ] 1 tbsp coconut oil

STEPS

1. Boil beans until soft, 40 min. Drain.
2. Warm palm oil, add the blend and cook 10 min.
3. Add beans, crayfish and seasoning. Simmer 10 min.
4. Slice plantain, toss in coconut oil and bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min.
5. Serve together.

Why it helps: Beans are rich in fibre and plant protein. Baking the dodo keeps it light.

DINNER Turkey Burgers & Sweet Potato Fries

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g turkey mince
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] 1 small carrot, finely grated
- [ ] 2 tbsp cassava flour
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic powder, ½ tsp paprika, salt
- [ ] 3 sweet potatoes, cut into fries
- [ ] Lettuce, tomato, avocado

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F. Toss fries in oil and salt and bake 30 min.
2. Mix turkey, flax egg, carrot, flour and spices. Shape 6 patties.
3. Bake the burgers on parchment 18–20 min, turning once.
4. Serve in lettuce cups or on buckwheat toast with tomato and avocado.

Why it helps: Burger night without wheat buns, cheese or processed sauce.

Picky eater trick: Let children build their own burger. Kids eat what they build.

WEEK 2

Day 11

Today's habit: 10 minutes outside in the morning sun.

BREAKFAST Coconut Quinoa Porridge with Mango

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup quinoa, rinsed well
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 1 cup water
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup (optional)
- [ ] 1 mango, diced

STEPS

1. Simmer quinoa, coconut milk, water and cinnamon for 15 min, stirring now and then.
2. Sweeten with maple if needed.
3. Top with mango.

Why it helps: Quinoa is a gluten-free seed with complete protein.

LUNCH Hidden-Veg Tomato Soup & Toast Soldiers

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 8 tomatoes (or 2 tins)
- [ ] 1 red pepper, 1 carrot, 1 small sweet potato
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 3 cups stock or water + 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] ½ cup coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tsp dried basil
- [ ] Buckwheat toast, cut into strips

STEPS

1. Soften onion and garlic in olive oil, 3 min.
2. Add all the vegetables, stock and basil. Simmer 20 min.
3. Blend until completely smooth.
4. Stir in coconut milk.
5. Serve with toast soldiers for dipping.

Why it helps: Five vegetables — and your child won't see a single one.

Kid tip: Smooth soups are a great "safe" food for children who dislike textures.

DINNER Ofada Rice & Mild Green Pepper Stew

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups ofada rice (or brown rice), washed
- [ ] 6 green peppers, 2 green scotch bonnets (fewer for kids)
- [ ] 2 onions
- [ ] 500 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 4 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 2 tsp iru (optional)
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt

STEPS

1. Boil the rice until tender, 35 min.
2. Cook beef with onion and seasoning until tender. Keep stock.
3. Blend peppers and onion roughly.
4. Warm palm oil gently, add pepper blend and cook 15 min.
5. Add beef, crayfish, iru and a little stock. Simmer 10 min.

Why it helps: Ofada is a whole-grain local rice with more fibre than white rice.

WEEK 2

Day 12

"You are building healthy habits that will last a lifetime."

BREAKFAST Green Smoothie Bowl

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 frozen bananas
- [ ] 1 cup frozen mango
- [ ] 1 handful spinach
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] Toppings: Crunchy Nut-Free Granola, berries, coconut

STEPS

1. Blend banana, mango, spinach and coconut milk until thick.
2. Pour into bowls.
3. Let children add their own toppings.

Why it helps: Mango and banana hide the spinach — it just tastes like ice cream.

Picky eater trick: Call it "Hulk ice cream" or "dinosaur smoothie". Fun names work!

LUNCH Chicken Shawarma Rice Bowl

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g chicken thighs
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin, paprika, turmeric; ½ tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, juice of 1 lemon
- [ ] 2 cups rice
- [ ] Cucumber, tomato, cabbage — chopped
- [ ] Garlic sauce: ½ cup coconut yogurt, 1 garlic clove, lemon, salt

STEPS

1. Mix spices, garlic, lemon and oil. Coat chicken and rest 20 min.
2. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 25 min, then slice.
3. Cook the rice.
4. Stir the garlic sauce together.
5. Build bowls: rice, chicken, salad, sauce.

Why it helps: Shawarma without the wheat wrap or mayonnaise — just as tasty.

DINNER Vegetable Soup with Fish & Boiled Yam

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 bunches ugu, finely chopped
- [ ] 2 bunches waterleaf or extra spinach
- [ ] 500 g tilapia or mackerel
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Boiled yam, to serve

STEPS

1. Season fish with onion and seasoning. Cook gently in 1 cup water, 10 min.
2. Add palm oil, pepper and crayfish. Cook 5 min.
3. Add waterleaf and cook 5 min.
4. Add ugu, stir and cook 3 min.
5. Serve with boiled yam.

Why it helps: Packed with iron, folate and magnesium from the greens.

WEEK 2

Day 13

It's Friday — Sweet Treat Day! See this week's sweet treats.

BREAKFAST Fluffy Sweet Potato Pancakes

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup mashed sweet potato
- [ ] 1 cup buckwheat flour
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] ¾ cup coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon, pinch of salt
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda + 1 tsp lemon juice
- [ ] Coconut oil, for the pan

STEPS

1. Mix sweet potato, flax egg and milk.
2. Stir in flour, cinnamon, salt and soda, then the lemon.
3. Cook small pancakes in a lightly oiled pan, 2–3 min each side.
4. Serve with coconut yogurt and berries.

Why it helps: Naturally sweet from the sweet potato — no sugar needed.

LUNCH Ghana Light Soup with Chicken & Rice Balls

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 kg chicken pieces
- [ ] 4 tomatoes, 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 2 garden eggs (optional)
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 6 cups water
- [ ] Rice balls (omo tuo): 2 cups soft-cooked rice

STEPS

1. Season chicken with onion, ginger and seasoning. Steam 10 min without water.
2. Add water, whole tomatoes, pepper and garden eggs. Boil 15 min.
3. Lift out the vegetables, blend smooth and return to the pot.
4. Simmer 20 min.
5. Mash the soft rice and shape into balls. Serve in the soup.

Why it helps: A light, clear, soothing soup — perfect when tummies are sensitive.

DINNER Beef Kebab Skewers with Rice & Salad

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g beef steak, cubed
- [ ] 1 red pepper, 1 onion — chunks
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil, juice of 1 lemon
- [ ] 1 tsp each paprika, garlic powder, thyme; salt
- [ ] Rice, to serve
- [ ] Cucumber & tomato salad

STEPS

1. Mix oil, lemon and spices. Coat beef and rest 20 min.
2. Thread beef and vegetables onto soaked skewers.
3. Bake at 220 °C / 425 °F for 15 min, turning once.
4. Serve with rice and salad.

Why it helps: Food on a stick is fun — children happily eat what's on a skewer.

WEEK 2

Day 14

Sunday: batch-cook day — bake bread, make granola, soak beans for the week.

BREAKFAST Fonio (Acha) Porridge with Coconut & Banana

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup fonio (acha), rinsed
- [ ] 2 cups water + 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] ½ tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 2 ripe bananas, sliced
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey or maple (optional)

STEPS

1. Bring water and coconut milk to the boil.
2. Stir in fonio and cinnamon. Cook 5–7 min on low.
3. Top with banana and a drizzle of honey.

Why it helps: Fonio is an ancient West African grain — gluten-free and quick to cook.

LUNCH Shepherd's Pie with Sweet Potato Mash

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g beef or lamb mince
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 carrots, 1 courgette — finely diced
- [ ] 1 tin chopped tomatoes
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 tbsp tapioca flour
- [ ] 1 kg sweet potatoes
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil

STEPS

1. Brown mince with onion. Add vegetables, tomatoes, thyme and seasoning. Simmer 20 min.
2. Stir in tapioca mixed with a little water to thicken.
3. Boil and mash sweet potatoes with olive oil and salt.
4. Spread mince in a dish and top with mash.
5. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min.

Why it helps: Comfort food with hidden vegetables in every spoonful.

DINNER Beef, Pumpkin & Potato Soup (inspired by Mama's soup)

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 2 cups pumpkin or butternut, cubed
- [ ] 3 Irish potatoes, cubed
- [ ] 2 carrots
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 6 cups water

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion, garlic, thyme and seasoning for 30 min until tender. Lift out and shred.
2. Add pumpkin, potato and carrot to the stock. Cook 15 min.
3. Blend smooth — or blend half and chop the rest tiny.
4. Return beef and simmer 5 min.
5. Serve with buckwheat bread.

Why it helps: Pumpkin and potato are root-vegetable carbs from the author's “foods to eat” list.

Kid tip: Same idea as Mama's Chicken, Potato & Carrot Soup — a new flavour for the same safe texture.

SWEET TREAT

Banana Bread Bites

No processed sugar
35 min · makes 16

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 very ripe bananas, mashed
- [ ] 1½ cups buckwheat flour
- [ ] 2 flax eggs
- [ ] ¼ cup melted coconut oil
- [ ] 2 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon, 1 tsp baking soda
- [ ] 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a square tin with parchment.
2. Mix banana, flax eggs, oil and maple.
3. Stir in flour, cinnamon and soda, then the vinegar.
4. Bake 25 min. Cool and cut into squares.

Why it helps: Sweetened almost entirely by banana. Perfect for lunch boxes too.

SWEET TREAT

Carob Fudge Bites

No processed sugar
15 min + chilling

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup soft pitted dates
- [ ] 3 tbsp carob powder
- [ ] 3 tbsp sunflower-seed butter
- [ ] 2 tbsp coconut oil
- [ ] Desiccated coconut, for rolling

STEPS

1. Blend dates, carob, seed butter and oil until sticky.
2. Roll into small balls.
3. Roll in coconut and chill 1 hour.

Why it helps: Tastes like chocolate fudge — no cocoa, no caffeine, no nuts.

Every Friday is Sweet Treat Day — because healing food should still feel like a celebration.

WEEK 3 · TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 3 shopping list

Everything for Days 15–21. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Spinach / ugu — 4 bunches
- [ ] Sukuma (collards) or kale — 2 bunches
- [ ] Broccoli — 1 head
- [ ] Tomatoes — 18
- [ ] Red peppers — 6, green pepper — 2
- [ ] Scotch bonnet — 4
- [ ] Onions — 12
- [ ] Garlic — 2 bulbs, ginger — 1 piece
- [ ] Carrots — 10
- [ ] Celery — 2 sticks
- [ ] Courgette — 1
- [ ] Green beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Garden eggs — 6
- [ ] Mushrooms — 200 g
- [ ] Sweet potatoes — 2
- [ ] Baby potatoes — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Potatoes — 1 kg
- [ ] Avocado — 1
- [ ] Frozen peas — 2 cups

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Ripe or half-ripe plantains — 3
- [ ] Green bananas (matoke) — 8 or green plantains — 4
- [ ] Mangoes — 2
- [ ] Bananas — 2
- [ ] Apple — 1
- [ ] Berries — 1 punnet
- [ ] Lemons — 3

Protein

- [ ] Beef cubes — 1.3 kg
- [ ] Beef steak — 400 g
- [ ] Beef mince — 500 g
- [ ] Chicken breast — 1 kg
- [ ] Chicken pieces — 500 g
- [ ] Turkey mince — 400 g
- [ ] Salmon fillets — 4
- [ ] White fish fillets — 500 g
- [ ] Tilapia or mackerel — 8
- [ ] Smoked mackerel — 1
- [ ] Black-eyed beans — 3 cups
- [ ] Butter/haricot beans — 2 tins
- [ ] Plain beans (no sugar) — 1 tin

Grains & flours

- [ ] Buckwheat flour, buckwheat groats
- [ ] Ground ogbono — ½ cup
- [ ] Pure millet flour — 3 cups
- [ ] Red lentils — 1 cup
- [ ] Long-grain rice — 6 cups
- [ ] Rice pasta — 800 g
- [ ] Rice noodles — 200 g
- [ ] Certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] Cassava flour
- [ ] Amala (yam flour)

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 7 tins
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 1 tub
- [ ] Passata — 1 jar
- [ ] Chopped tomatoes — 1 tin
- [ ] Red palm oil, olive & avocado oil
- [ ] Coconut aminos, carob powder
- [ ] Chia seeds, ground flaxseed
- [ ] Pure maple syrup, dates
- [ ] Tapioca flour
- [ ] Waakye leaves (optional)

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Fresh parsley or dill, mint
- [ ] Fresh coriander
- [ ] Oregano, thyme, sage
- [ ] Curry powder, cumin, turmeric, paprika
- [ ] Ground ginger, cayenne
- [ ] Cinnamon, garlic & onion powder

WEEK 3

Day 15

Week 3 — halfway there. Be proud of every small step.

BREAKFAST Buckwheat Crêpes with Berries

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup buckwheat flour
- [ ] 1¼ cups coconut milk or water
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] Pinch of salt
- [ ] 1 tbsp coconut oil
- [ ] Berries & coconut yogurt, to serve

STEPS

1. Whisk flour, milk, flax egg and salt to a thin batter. Rest 10 min.
2. Heat a little oil in a non-stick pan.
3. Pour a thin layer, swirl, cook 1–2 min, flip, 1 min.
4. Fill with berries and coconut yogurt and roll up.

Why it helps: Thin, soft crêpes are easy for little hands — and full of magnesium.

LUNCH Ogbono Soup with Beef & Amala

45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ cup ground ogbono
- [ ] 500 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 scotch bonnet, 1 onion
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 cup ugu or spinach
- [ ] Amala (yam flour), to serve

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning until tender. Keep 3 cups stock.
2. Warm palm oil on low, stir in ogbono for 1 min only.
3. Whisk in the stock little by little.
4. Add beef, pepper and crayfish. Simmer 10 min.
5. Add greens and serve with amala.

Why it helps: Ogbono's soft, smooth texture is gentle on the gut.

DINNER Creamy Chicken & Spinach Pasta

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g rice or gluten-free pasta
- [ ] 400 g chicken breast, sliced
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, 1 onion
- [ ] 2 handfuls spinach
- [ ] 2 tbsp nutritional yeast (optional), salt, pepper

STEPS

1. Cook the pasta as the pack says.
2. Cook chicken with onion and garlic in olive oil, 8 min.
3. Pour in coconut milk and nutritional yeast. Simmer 5 min.
4. Stir in spinach until wilted.
5. Toss with the pasta.

Why it helps: A creamy, cheesy-tasting pasta with no dairy at all.

WEEK 3

Day 16

Today's habit: bounce, dance or jump for 10 minutes.

BREAKFAST Boiled Plantain & Garden Egg Sauce

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 ripe or half-ripe plantains
- [ ] 6 garden eggs
- [ ] 2 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes, ½ scotch bonnet
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish
- [ ] 1 small smoked mackerel, flaked (optional)
- [ ] Salt

STEPS

1. Boil plantains in their skins 15 min.
2. Boil garden eggs 10 min, peel and mash.
3. Warm palm oil, add onion, tomato and pepper. Cook 5 min.
4. Add garden egg, crayfish and fish. Cook 5 min.
5. Serve with the plantain.

Why it helps: Garden eggs are high in fibre and gentle on digestion.

LUNCH Lentil & Sweet Potato Soup

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup red lentils, rinsed
- [ ] 2 sweet potatoes, cubed
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 carrots, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp cumin, ½ tsp turmeric
- [ ] 5 cups stock or water + 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Juice of ½ lemon
- [ ] Buckwheat bread, to serve

STEPS

1. Soften onion, carrot and garlic in oil, 5 min.
2. Add spices, lentils, sweet potato and stock.
3. Simmer 20 min until soft.
4. Blend smooth and add lemon.

Why it helps: Lentils give protein, iron and fibre — great support for steady energy.

DINNER Nut-Free Chicken Suya & Yam Fries

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g chicken breast, cut into strips
- [ ] 2 tsp paprika, 1 tsp ground ginger
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic & onion powder, salt
- [ ] ¼ tsp cayenne (or none for kids)
- [ ] ½ medium yam, cut into fries
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] Sliced onion, tomato, cucumber

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F.
2. Toss yam fries in oil and salt and bake 25–30 min.
3. Rub chicken with spices and oil. Thread onto skewers.
4. Bake 12–15 min, turning once.
5. Serve with fresh onion, tomato and cucumber.

Why it helps: Classic suya spice uses groundnut — this version is nut-free and just as tasty.

WEEK 3

Day 17

"Every meal you cook is an act of love."

BREAKFAST Mango Chia Pudding

5 min + overnight

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ cup chia seeds
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] 1 mango, blended
- [ ] Diced mango, to top

STEPS

1. Stir chia, coconut milk and maple. Rest 10 min and stir again.
2. Chill overnight.
3. Layer with mango purée and top with diced mango.

Why it helps: Chia seeds are the author's top tip for constipation — gentle soluble fibre.

LUNCH Coconut Rice with Pepper Fish

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups long-grain rice
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 2 cups water
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 red peppers, 1 scotch bonnet — blended
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp curry, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 4 tilapia or mackerel
- [ ] Fresh coriander, lemon

STEPS

1. Cook the pepper blend in olive oil 5 min.
2. Add rice, coconut milk, water and spices.
3. Cover and cook on low 25 min.
4. Rub fish with coriander, lemon and salt. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min.
5. Serve together.

Why it helps: Coconut milk adds richness without any dairy.

DINNER Mini Meatballs in Tomato Sauce

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g beef mince
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] 2 tbsp cassava flour
- [ ] ½ courgette, finely grated
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic powder, 1 tsp oregano, salt
- [ ] 1 jar passata (700 g)
- [ ] 400 g rice pasta

STEPS

1. Mix mince, flax egg, flour, courgette and seasoning. Roll 24 small balls.
2. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 15 min.
3. Warm passata with oregano. Add meatballs and simmer 10 min.
4. Cook the pasta and serve with meatballs and sauce.

Why it helps: Hidden courgette in every meatball. Cook extra for lunch boxes.

WEEK 3

Day 18

Today's habit: lemon balm tea 2 hours before bed.

BREAKFAST Baked Akara Bites & Millet Porridge

40 min + soaking

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups black-eyed beans, soaked & peeled
- [ ] 1 small onion, ½ scotch bonnet, salt
- [ ] Olive oil, for the tin
- [ ] 1 cup pure millet flour
- [ ] 4 cups water, 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 3 dates, chopped

STEPS

1. Blend beans, onion, pepper and salt with very little water. Whisk 3 min until fluffy.
2. Spoon into an oiled mini muffin tin. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20–25 min.
3. Whisk millet flour with 1 cup cold water.
4. Boil remaining water with dates, stir in the millet and cook 8 min. Add coconut milk.

Why it helps: A classic Nigerian breakfast — gluten-free, egg-free, corn-free and baked.

LUNCH Beef & Veg Stir-Fry with Rice Noodles

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g beef steak, thinly sliced
- [ ] 1 head broccoli, 2 carrots, 1 red pepper
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 3 tbsp coconut aminos
- [ ] 1 tsp tapioca flour + 2 tbsp water
- [ ] 200 g rice noodles
- [ ] 2 tbsp avocado oil

STEPS

1. Soak or cook noodles as the pack says.
2. Stir-fry beef in hot oil 3 min. Set aside.
3. Stir-fry vegetables, garlic and ginger 4 min.
4. Return beef, add coconut aminos and tapioca mix.
5. Toss with noodles until glossy.

Why it helps: Quick, colourful and soy-free — coconut aminos replaces soy sauce.

DINNER Sukuma Wiki, Beef & Millet Ugali

45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 bunches sukuma (collard greens) or kale, sliced
- [ ] 400 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 2 cups pure millet (wimbi) or sorghum flour
- [ ] 4 cups water

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning until tender.
2. Add tomatoes and cook 5 min. Add greens, cook 5 min.
3. For ugali: boil water, add flour slowly, stirring hard.
4. Keep stirring 5–8 min until thick and pulling from the pot.
5. Shape and serve with the greens.

Why it helps: Ugali is usually made with maize. Millet keeps the Kenyan classic corn-free.

Swap it: Kale or spinach works perfectly outside Kenya.

WEEK 3

Day 19

"Your child is not giving you a hard time. They are having a hard time."

BREAKFAST Banana-Carob Overnight Oats

5 min + overnight

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 2 ripe bananas, mashed
- [ ] 1 tbsp carob powder
- [ ] 1 tbsp chia seeds

STEPS

1. Stir everything together.
2. Divide into jars and chill overnight.
3. Top with sliced banana.

Why it helps: Carob tastes like chocolate — with no caffeine.

LUNCH Chakalaka Bean Stew with Rice

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 tins butter beans or haricot beans, drained
- [ ] 1 onion, 1 red & 1 green pepper, diced
- [ ] 2 carrots, grated
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 1 tsp pure curry powder
- [ ] 3 tomatoes, chopped
- [ ] Rice, to serve

STEPS

1. Soften onion, peppers and garlic in oil, 5 min.
2. Add ginger, curry and carrot. Cook 3 min.
3. Add tomatoes and simmer 10 min.
4. Stir in beans and heat through.
5. Serve with rice.

Why it helps: A South African favourite — colourful, mild and full of fibre.

Allergy note: Most tinned baked beans have added sugar. Use plain beans.

DINNER Baked Salmon, Potatoes & Green Beans

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 salmon fillets
- [ ] 1 kg baby potatoes, halved
- [ ] 2 cups green beans
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 lemon, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] Fresh parsley or dill, salt

STEPS

1. Toss potatoes with oil and salt. Roast at 200 °C / 400 °F for 25 min.
2. Add salmon and green beans to the tray. Top with lemon, garlic and herbs.
3. Roast 12–15 min more.
4. Serve straight from the tray.

Why it helps: Salmon is low in mercury and rich in omega-3 for the brain.

WEEK 3

Day 20

It's Friday — Sweet Treat Day!

BREAKFAST Apple Cinnamon Buckwheat Porridge

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup buckwheat groats, soaked overnight & rinsed
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 1 apple, grated
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup

STEPS

1. Simmer buckwheat and coconut milk 10 min.
2. Stir in apple and cinnamon. Cook 5 min.
3. Sweeten with maple and serve warm.

Why it helps: Apple adds natural sweetness and fibre.

LUNCH Waakye with Fish Stew

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups rice
- [ ] 1 cup black-eyed beans, soaked
- [ ] A few dried sorghum (waakye) leaves, or ¼ tsp baking soda
- [ ] 4 mackerel or tilapia
- [ ] 6 tomatoes, 2 red peppers, 1 onion — blended
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Salt

STEPS

1. Boil beans with waakye leaves 30 min.
2. Add rice and more water. Cook until tender, 20 min. Remove leaves.
3. Cook the tomato blend in oil 15 min until thick.
4. Add fish and seasoning. Simmer 10 min.
5. Serve waakye with the fish stew.

Why it helps: Rice and beans together make a complete protein.

DINNER Friday Fish & Chips with Mushy Peas

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g white fish fillets
- [ ] 1 cup cassava flour, 1 tsp paprika, salt
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 kg potatoes, cut into chips
- [ ] 2 cups frozen peas
- [ ] Fresh mint, lemon

STEPS

1. Toss chips in 2 tbsp oil and salt. Bake at 220 °C / 425 °F for 35 min.
2. Brush fish with oil, coat in seasoned flour.
3. Bake fish 12–15 min until golden.
4. Boil peas 3 min and mash with mint, olive oil and salt.
5. Serve with lemon.

Why it helps: A British classic, baked not fried — no wheat batter.

WEEK 3

Day 21

Sunday: batch-cook day — make seasoning mix and freeze soup portions.

BREAKFAST Sunday Breakfast Plate

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g turkey mince
- [ ] 1 tsp dried sage or thyme, ½ tsp garlic powder, salt
- [ ] 500 g baby potatoes, halved
- [ ] 200 g mushrooms
- [ ] 2 tomatoes, halved
- [ ] 1 avocado
- [ ] 1 tin plain beans (no added sugar)

STEPS

1. Roast potatoes at 200 °C / 400 °F for 25 min.
2. Mix turkey with herbs and salt. Shape 8 small patties.
3. Pan-cook patties 4 min each side.
4. Cook mushrooms and tomatoes in the same pan.
5. Serve with warm beans and avocado.

Why it helps: A full breakfast with no pork sausages, bacon or eggs.

LUNCH Matoke (Green Banana & Beef Stew)

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 8 green cooking bananas (matoke) or 4 green plantains
- [ ] 400 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 1 onion, 3 tomatoes
- [ ] 1 carrot, 1 green pepper
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] Fresh coriander

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and garlic until tender.
2. Add tomatoes, carrot and pepper. Cook 5 min.
3. Peel bananas (oil your hands) and add with water to cover.
4. Simmer 20 min until soft.
5. Mash a little to thicken. Finish with coriander.

Why it helps: Green banana feeds good gut bacteria — on the author's healing-the-gut list.

DINNER Chicken & Rice Soup

45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken pieces
- [ ] ½ cup rice
- [ ] 2 carrots, 2 celery sticks
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 6 cups water
- [ ] Fresh parsley

STEPS

1. Simmer chicken with onion, garlic, thyme and seasoning for 25 min. Lift out and shred.
2. Add rice, carrot and celery. Cook 15 min.
3. Blend the vegetables first if your child prefers it smooth.
4. Return chicken and finish with parsley.

Why it helps: Simple, soothing chicken soup — the best food when someone is unwell.

SWEET TREAT

Baked Cinnamon Apples with Coconut Cream

No processed sugar
35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 apples, cored
- [ ] 2 tbsp raisins or chopped dates
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp coconut oil
- [ ] Whipped coconut cream

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F.
2. Fill apples with dates, cinnamon and a little coconut oil.
3. Bake 25–30 min until soft.
4. Serve warm with coconut cream.

Why it helps: Warm, soft and comforting — like apple pie without the pastry.

SWEET TREAT

Mango Coconut Rice Pudding

No processed sugar
35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ cup short-grain rice
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 1 cup water
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] ½ tsp vanilla powder
- [ ] 1 mango, diced

STEPS

1. Simmer rice in water 15 min.
2. Add coconut milk, maple and vanilla. Cook 15 min, stirring.
3. Serve warm or chilled, topped with mango.

Why it helps: Creamy, dairy-free and naturally sweet.

Every Friday is **Sweet Treat Day** — because healing food should still feel like a celebration.

WEEK 4 · TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 4 shopping list

Everything for Days 22–28. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Spinach / ugu — 4 bunches
- [ ] Romaine or gem lettuce — 2
- [ ] Cabbage — 1
- [ ] Tomatoes — 22
- [ ] Red peppers — 7, other peppers — 6
- [ ] Scotch bonnet — 6
- [ ] Onions — 14
- [ ] Garlic — 2 bulbs, ginger — 1 piece
- [ ] Carrots — 8
- [ ] Green beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Broccoli — 1 head
- [ ] Mushrooms — 100 g
- [ ] Potatoes — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Parsnips or sweet potatoes — 2
- [ ] Avocados — 3

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Yam — 1 medium
- [ ] Ripe plantains — 2
- [ ] Green plantains — 4
- [ ] Bananas — 2
- [ ] Mangoes — 2
- [ ] Pineapple — 1
- [ ] Pawpaw — 1 small
- [ ] Passion fruit — 2 (optional)
- [ ] Lemons — 3, limes — 2

Protein

- [ ] Beef cubes — 600 g
- [ ] Chicken breast — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Chicken drumsticks — 8
- [ ] Chicken (whole or pieces) — 1 kg
- [ ] Turkey mince — 700 g
- [ ] Turkey thighs — 1 kg
- [ ] Fresh fish (tilapia/catfish) — 1.1 kg
- [ ] White fish — 500 g
- [ ] Smoked mackerel — 1
- [ ] Sardines in olive oil — 1 tin
- [ ] Honey beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Kidney beans — 2 tins
- [ ] Black beans — 1 tin

Grains & flours

- [ ] Rice spaghetti — 400 g
- [ ] Long-grain rice — 8 cups
- [ ] Pure millet flour — 1 cup
- [ ] Tiger nuts — 1 cup
- [ ] Cassava flour (for flatbreads)
- [ ] Pounded yam flour

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 4 tins
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 2 tubs
- [ ] Dairy-free cheese — 1 pack
- [ ] Palm nut concentrate — 1 tin
- [ ] Passata — 1 jar, tomato paste
- [ ] Red palm, olive & avocado oil
- [ ] Coconut aminos, raw honey
- [ ] Mustard (check label)
- [ ] Nutritional yeast
- [ ] Ground flaxseed, tapioca flour

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Scent leaves or basil
- [ ] Utazi or uziza (or basil)
- [ ] Ogiri (optional), crayfish
- [ ] Pepper soup spice (pure)
- [ ] Rosemary, thyme, oregano, bay
- [ ] Cumin, paprika, curry, garlic powder

WEEK 4

Day 22

Week 4 — look how far you've come. Keep going, Mama and Papa.

BREAKFAST Beans & Ripe Plantain Porridge

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups honey beans (oloyin), soaked
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes, 1 pepper — blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 2 ripe plantains, cubed
- [ ] Salt

STEPS

1. Boil beans until very soft, 45 min.
2. Add the blend, palm oil, crayfish and seasoning.
3. Add plantain and cook 10 min.
4. Mash a little until creamy.

Why it helps: Honey beans are naturally sweet — children love them.

LUNCH Chicken Caesar-Style Lettuce Wraps

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken breast
- [ ] 1 head romaine or gem lettuce
- [ ] Dressing: ½ cup coconut yogurt, 1 garlic clove
- [ ] Juice of ½ lemon, 1 tsp mustard (check label)
- [ ] 2 tbsp nutritional yeast, salt
- [ ] Buckwheat bread, cubed & toasted

STEPS

1. Season and bake chicken at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min. Slice.
2. Whisk the dressing together.
3. Toast bread cubes in a little olive oil for croutons.
4. Fill lettuce leaves with chicken, croutons and dressing.

Why it helps: Caesar dressing usually has egg and cheese. This one has neither.

DINNER Banga Soup with Fish & Rice

45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 tin palm nut concentrate (400 g)
- [ ] 500 g fresh fish (tilapia or catfish)
- [ ] 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Handful scent leaves or basil
- [ ] 3 cups water
- [ ] Rice, to serve

STEPS

1. Bring palm nut concentrate and water to the boil. Simmer 15 min.
2. Add onion, pepper, crayfish and seasoning.
3. Add fish gently and cook 10 min.
4. Stir in scent leaves.
5. Serve with rice.

Why it helps: A Delta favourite — rich in vitamin E from the palm fruit.

WEEK 4

Day 23

Today's habit: add a spoon of seeds to one meal.

BREAKFAST Tropical Granola Bowl

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups coconut yogurt
- [ ] 1 cup Crunchy Nut-Free Granola
- [ ] 1 mango, 1 cup pineapple — diced
- [ ] 2 passion fruit (optional)

STEPS

1. Spoon yogurt into bowls.
2. Top with fruit and granola.
3. Add passion fruit seeds.

Why it helps: Coconut yogurt and fruit feed good gut bacteria.

LUNCH Jollof Spaghetti

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g rice spaghetti
- [ ] 500 g chicken, diced
- [ ] 5 tomatoes, 2 red peppers, 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet — blended
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato paste, 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp curry, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 cup mixed carrots & green beans, diced

STEPS

1. Cook chicken with seasoning until done.
2. Fry tomato paste in oil 3 min. Add blend and cook 15 min.
3. Add spices, vegetables and chicken.
4. Cook spaghetti until just soft and toss through the sauce.

Why it helps: Jollof flavour + pasta = a guaranteed hit with children.

DINNER Honey-Garlic Chicken, Rice & Broccoli

45 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 8 chicken drumsticks
- [ ] 2 tbsp raw honey
- [ ] 3 tbsp coconut aminos
- [ ] 3 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger — grated
- [ ] 1 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] Rice and steamed broccoli

STEPS

1. Mix honey, coconut aminos, garlic, ginger and oil.
2. Coat drumsticks and rest 15 min.
3. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 40 min, basting halfway.
4. Serve with rice and broccoli.

Why it helps: Sticky, sweet and savoury — with real honey instead of sugar.

WEEK 4

Day 24

"Small steps every day add up to big changes."

BREAKFAST Millet Porridge with Tiger Nut Milk

15 min + soaking

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup tiger nuts, soaked overnight
- [ ] 3 cups water + 3 dates
- [ ] 1 cup pure millet flour
- [ ] 3 cups water, for porridge
- [ ] Pinch of ginger and cloves

STEPS

1. Blend tiger nuts, 3 cups water and dates. Strain through a cloth — this is your milk.
2. Whisk millet flour with 1 cup cold water.
3. Boil 2 cups water with ginger and cloves, stir in millet.
4. Cook 8 min, then stir in tiger nut milk.

Why it helps: Tiger nuts are tubers, not nuts — a creamy, naturally sweet dairy-free milk.

LUNCH Chicken Fajitas

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken breast, sliced
- [ ] 2 peppers, 1 onion — sliced
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin, paprika, garlic powder; salt
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil, juice of 1 lime
- [ ] 6 cassava flatbreads (see Basics)
- [ ] Avocado, tomato salsa, lettuce

STEPS

1. Toss chicken and vegetables with spices, oil and lime.
2. Cook in a hot pan 10 min until done.
3. Warm the flatbreads.
4. Fill with chicken, avocado, salsa and lettuce.

Why it helps: Most tortillas are made with corn or wheat. Cassava keeps fajita night safe.

DINNER Fish Pepper Soup with Yam

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g fish (catfish or tilapia), in steaks
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure pepper soup spice
- [ ] 1 onion, ½ scotch bonnet
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] Handful scent leaves or basil
- [ ] ½ yam, cubed
- [ ] 6 cups water

STEPS

1. Boil yam in the water 10 min.
2. Add onion, spice, pepper and seasoning.
3. Add fish gently and simmer 10 min.
4. Finish with scent leaves.

Why it helps: Warm pepper soup spices are traditionally used to soothe the tummy.

Kid tip: Use very little pepper for children — add extra to adult bowls.

WEEK 4

Day 25

Today's habit: screens off one hour before bed.

BREAKFAST Banana-Avocado Green Smoothie & Toast

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 ripe bananas
- [ ] ½ avocado
- [ ] 1 handful spinach
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground flaxseed
- [ ] Buckwheat toast

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Serve with buckwheat toast.

Why it helps: Avocado makes it creamy and filling. Flax adds omega-3.

LUNCH Nigerian Beef Stew, Rice & Steamed Veg

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 8 tomatoes, 3 red peppers, 2 onions, 1 scotch bonnet — blended
- [ ] 4 tbsp olive or palm oil
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp curry, 2 bay leaves
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] Rice
- [ ] Carrots & green beans, steamed

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning until tender. Keep the stock.
2. Cook the blend in a dry pot 10 min to reduce.
3. Add oil and spices. Cook 15 min until rich.
4. Add beef and a little stock. Simmer 10 min.
5. Serve with rice and steamed vegetables.

Why it helps: Classic Sunday stew — made without stock cubes or frying the meat.

DINNER Stuffed Peppers with Turkey & Rice

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 large peppers, tops cut off
- [ ] 400 g turkey mince
- [ ] 1 cup cooked rice
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes, chopped
- [ ] 1 tsp oregano, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] ½ cup dairy-free cheese (optional)

STEPS

1. Brown turkey and onion. Add tomatoes, oregano, seasoning. Cook 10 min.
2. Stir in the rice.
3. Fill the peppers. Top with cheese.
4. Bake covered with parchment at 190 °C / 375 °F for 30 min.

Why it helps: Colourful peppers are packed with vitamin C.

WEEK 4

Day 26

"Celebrate the bite, not the plate."

BREAKFAST Breakfast Burritos

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 6 cassava flatbreads (see Basics)
- [ ] 300 g turkey mince
- [ ] 2 potatoes, diced small
- [ ] 1 tin black beans, drained
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp cumin, salt
- [ ] 1 avocado, tomato salsa

STEPS

1. Roast potatoes with oil and salt at 220 °C / 425 °F for 20 min.
2. Cook turkey with spices 8 min.
3. Warm beans.
4. Fill flatbreads with everything and roll up.

Why it helps: A protein-packed breakfast that holds energy until lunch.

LUNCH Ofe Nsala (White Soup) with Chicken

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 kg chicken (or catfish)
- [ ] 4 small pieces yam (to thicken)
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 1 tsp ogiri (optional)
- [ ] Handful utazi or uziza leaves (or basil)
- [ ] Pounded yam

STEPS

1. Cook chicken with seasoning in 5 cups water, 25 min.
2. Boil yam separately, pound or blend until smooth.
3. Add pepper, crayfish and ogiri to the chicken.
4. Stir in small lumps of yam to thicken. Cook 10 min.
5. Add leaves and serve.

Why it helps: No palm oil — a light, peppery soup thickened naturally with yam.

DINNER Fish Tacos with Mango Salsa

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g white fish
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp cumin, salt
- [ ] 6 cassava flatbreads
- [ ] 2 cups shredded cabbage
- [ ] Salsa: 1 mango, ½ red onion, coriander, lime
- [ ] Coconut yogurt, to drizzle

STEPS

1. Season fish and bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 12 min. Flake.
2. Mix mango, onion, coriander and lime.
3. Warm the flatbreads.
4. Fill with cabbage, fish, salsa and yogurt.

Why it helps: Fresh, fruity and fun — children love the sweet mango.

WEEK 4

Day 27

It's Friday — Sweet Treat Day!

BREAKFAST Boiled Yam & Sardine-Tomato Sauce

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ yam, sliced
- [ ] 1 tin sardines in olive oil or water
- [ ] 3 tomatoes, 1 onion, ½ scotch bonnet
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] Handful spinach
- [ ] Salt

STEPS

1. Boil yam 15–20 min.
2. Cook onion, tomato and pepper in oil 8 min.
3. Add sardines, break up gently.
4. Stir in spinach. Serve with the yam.

Why it helps: Sardines are small, low-mercury fish packed with omega-3 and calcium.

Shopping tip: Choose sardines in olive oil or water — not in soybean oil or sauce.

LUNCH Kenyan Coconut Bean Stew (Maharagwe) & Rice

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 tins kidney beans, drained
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 tomatoes
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] ½ tsp turmeric, 1 tsp cumin, salt
- [ ] Fresh coriander
- [ ] Rice, to serve

STEPS

1. Soften onion and garlic in oil, 3 min.
2. Add tomatoes and spices. Cook 5 min.
3. Add beans and coconut milk. Simmer 15 min.
4. Finish with coriander. Serve with rice.

Why it helps: Creamy, mild and full of fibre — a Kenyan coastal classic.

DINNER Friday Pizza Night: Chicken & Veggie

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cassava flatbread pizza bases
- [ ] 1 cup passata, 1 tsp oregano
- [ ] 1 cup dairy-free cheese
- [ ] Cooked chicken, peppers, mushrooms, red onion
- [ ] Pineapple chunks (optional)
- [ ] Olive oil

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F.
2. Spread passata over the bases, sprinkle oregano.
3. Add cheese and toppings.
4. Bake 10–12 min until bubbling.

Why it helps: Pizza is back — make it a Friday family tradition.

Picky eater trick: Put toppings in little bowls and let each child design their own.

WEEK 4

Day 28

Sunday: batch-cook day — next week is the final stretch!

BREAKFAST Coconut Rice Porridge with Pawpaw

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup rice
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 2 cups water
- [ ] ½ tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey or maple (optional)
- [ ] 1 small pawpaw (papaya), diced

STEPS

1. Simmer rice in water 15 min.
2. Add coconut milk and cinnamon. Cook 10 min until creamy.
3. Top with pawpaw.

Why it helps: Pawpaw contains natural enzymes that help digestion.

LUNCH Sunday Roast Turkey Thighs & Gravy

1 hr 20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 kg turkey thighs
- [ ] 1 kg potatoes
- [ ] 4 carrots, 2 parsnips or sweet potatoes
- [ ] 1 garlic bulb, 1 lemon
- [ ] Fresh rosemary & thyme
- [ ] 3 tbsp avocado oil, salt
- [ ] 1 tbsp tapioca flour

STEPS

1. Rub turkey with oil, salt, herbs and lemon. Roast at 190 °C / 375 °F for 1 hr.
2. Parboil potatoes 8 min, toss in oil and roast with the vegetables 45 min.
3. Rest turkey 10 min.
4. Thicken pan juices with tapioca and water for gravy.

Why it helps: Turkey is lean, gentle protein — a lovely change from chicken.

DINNER Green Plantain Porridge

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 green (unripe) plantains, cubed
- [ ] 2 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion + 2 tomatoes + 1 pepper, blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 small smoked mackerel, flaked (not tuna)
- [ ] 1 cup ugu or spinach

STEPS

1. Warm the oil, add the blend and cook 5 min.
2. Add plantain, crayfish, seasoning and water to just cover.
3. Cook 20 min until soft. Mash a little to thicken.
4. Stir in the fish and greens. Cook 3 min.

Why it helps: Green plantain is full of resistant starch that feeds good gut bacteria.

SWEET TREAT

Sweet Potato Carob Brownies

No processed sugar
40 min · makes 16

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup mashed sweet potato
- [ ] ¾ cup buckwheat flour
- [ ] ⅓ cup carob powder
- [ ] 2 flax eggs
- [ ] ⅓ cup pure maple syrup
- [ ] ¼ cup melted coconut oil
- [ ] ½ tsp baking soda + 1 tsp lemon juice

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a square tin.
2. Mix sweet potato, flax eggs, maple and oil.
3. Stir in flour, carob and soda, then lemon.
4. Bake 25 min. Cool fully before cutting.

Why it helps: Fudgy brownies with a secret vegetable inside.

SWEET TREAT

Strawberry Coconut Cheesecake Cups

No processed sugar
20 min + chilling

YOU NEED

- [ ] Base: 1 cup dates + ½ cup sunflower seeds + ½ cup gluten-free oats
- [ ] 2 cups thick coconut yogurt
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] 1 cup strawberries, chopped
- [ ] Squeeze of lemon

STEPS

1. Blitz the base ingredients and press into 6 small cups.
2. Mix yogurt, maple and lemon. Spoon on top.
3. Top with strawberries. Chill 1 hour.

Why it helps: No-bake, no dairy, no nuts — a party-worthy treat.

Every Friday is Sweet Treat Day — because healing food should still feel like a celebration.

WEEK 5 · TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 5 shopping list

Everything for Days 29–30. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Cocoyam leaves or spinach — 4 bunches
- [ ] Tomatoes — 10
- [ ] Scotch bonnet — 2
- [ ] Onions — 6
- [ ] Garlic — 1 bulb
- [ ] Carrots — 4
- [ ] Celery — 2 sticks
- [ ] Cabbage — ½
- [ ] Lettuce — 1
- [ ] Avocados — 2

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Ripe plantains — 9
- [ ] Apples — 2
- [ ] Berries — 2 punnets
- [ ] Limes — 2, lemon — 1

Protein

- [ ] Chicken pieces — 1 kg
- [ ] Chicken breast — 500 g
- [ ] Beef mince — 500 g
- [ ] Smoked mackerel — 1
- [ ] Black beans — 1 tin

Grains & flours

- [ ] Short-grain rice — 1 cup
- [ ] Long-grain rice — 3 cups
- [ ] Rice noodles — 150 g
- [ ] Cassava flour

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 4 tins (2 chilled for cream)
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 1 tub
- [ ] Dairy-free cheese
- [ ] Tomato paste
- [ ] Ground egusi (optional)
- [ ] Ground flaxseed, baking soda
- [ ] Pure maple syrup
- [ ] Mustard (check label)

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Fresh parsley, coriander
- [ ] Thyme, oregano, curry, bay leaves
- [ ] Cumin, paprika, cinnamon
- [ ] Healing Seasoning Mix

WEEK 5

Day 29

The final stretch — two more days. You've got this.

BREAKFAST Cinnamon Apple Rice Pudding

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup short-grain rice
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 2 cups water
- [ ] 2 apples, grated
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup

STEPS

1. Simmer rice in water 15 min.
2. Add coconut milk, apple and cinnamon.
3. Cook 10 min until creamy.
4. Sweeten with maple.

Why it helps: A warm, cosy breakfast — perfect for children who love soft foods.

LUNCH Kontomire Stew with Boiled Plantain

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 bunches cocoyam leaves or spinach, chopped
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion, 3 tomatoes, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 2 tbsp ground egusi (optional)
- [ ] 1 smoked mackerel, flaked
- [ ] 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 4 plantains, boiled

STEPS

1. Cook onion, tomato and pepper in palm oil 10 min.
2. Mix egusi with water and add. Cook 5 min.
3. Add fish and seasoning.
4. Stir in greens and cook 5 min.
5. Serve with boiled plantain.

Why it helps: A Ghanaian favourite full of iron from the leafy greens.

DINNER Chicken Noodle Soup

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken breast
- [ ] 150 g rice noodles
- [ ] 2 carrots, 2 celery sticks
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 6 cups water
- [ ] Fresh parsley

STEPS

1. Simmer chicken with onion, garlic, thyme and seasoning 20 min. Shred.
2. Add carrot and celery. Cook 10 min.
3. Add noodles and cook 5 min.
4. Return chicken and finish with parsley.

Why it helps: Soft noodles and gentle broth — easy on sensitive tummies.

WEEK 5

Day 30

Day 30 — you did it! Celebrate together tonight.

BREAKFAST Celebration Plantain Pancake Stack

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 very ripe plantains
- [ ] ½ cup cassava flour
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] ½ cup coconut milk
- [ ] ½ tsp baking soda + squeeze of lemon
- [ ] Whipped coconut cream & berries

STEPS

1. Blend plantain, flour, flax egg, milk and soda; add lemon.
2. Cook small pancakes in a lightly oiled pan.
3. Stack high with coconut cream and berries between layers.

Why it helps: A celebration breakfast for 30 days of hard work.

LUNCH Party Jollof Plate

1 hr 15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] Jollof Rice with Baked Chicken (Day 3)
- [ ] 3 ripe plantains, sliced & baked
- [ ] Coleslaw: ½ cabbage, 2 carrots — shredded
- [ ] Dressing: ½ cup coconut yogurt, lemon, 1 tsp mustard, salt

STEPS

1. Make the jollof and chicken from Day 3.
2. Bake plantain slices at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min.
3. Mix cabbage, carrot and dressing.
4. Serve a big party plate for everyone.

Why it helps: Party coleslaw usually has egg mayonnaise. This dressing is egg-free.

DINNER Build-Your-Own Taco Bar

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g beef mince
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin, paprika, oregano, garlic powder; salt
- [ ] 8 cassava flatbreads
- [ ] 1 tin black beans
- [ ] Guacamole: 2 avocados, lime, salt
- [ ] Salsa, lettuce, dairy-free cheese

STEPS

1. Brown mince with spices. Add a splash of water and simmer 10 min.
2. Warm beans and flatbreads.
3. Make guacamole.
4. Put everything in bowls and let everyone build their own.

Why it helps: A fun, hands-on celebration dinner — every child chooses their own plate.

Picky eater trick: Children who help choose and build their food eat more of it.

PART 3

Extra help

Quick meals for hard days, where to shop, and a few words before you go.

FOR THE HARD DAYS

15-minute rescue meals

Some days are just hard. Meltdowns, no sleep, no energy. These meals take 15 minutes or less — and they're still safe and healing.

From the freezer

- Mama's chicken & potato soup + buckwheat toast
- Frozen meatballs + passata + rice pasta
- Banana oat muffins + a smoothie

From the cupboard

- Rice noodles + coconut milk + spinach + leftover chicken
- Sardines in tomato sauce + boiled yam
- Tinned beans + rice + avocado

No cooking at all

- Cassava wrap + leftover chicken + avocado
- Coconut yogurt + granola + fruit
- DIY “lunchable” plate: rice crackers, chicken, cucumber, grapes

Leftover makeovers

- Jollof rice → fried rice next day
- Butternut mac → baked mac bites
- Roast chicken → soup, wraps, fried rice
- Stew → pour over pasta or boiled yam

Be kind to yourself

A simple safe meal is a win. Cereal-for-dinner days happen to every parent — just make it a safe one.

MAKE SHOPPING EASIER

Allergy-friendly brands near you

Always read the label — brands can change their recipes. Many gluten-free products still contain corn or egg.

Nigeria

Swallows: Ola-Ola & Iyan Ado pounded yam flour, plantain flour

Rice: Ofada, Mama Gold, Royal Stallion

Dairy-free: Kara or Chaokoh coconut milk, homemade tigernut milk (kunu aya)

Oils: Figaro extra virgin olive oil, unrefined red palm oil

Shops: Spar, Prince Ebeano, Justrite, Grand Square, local markets

Ghana

Swallows: Pure cassava or plantain fufu flour (no corn), yam flour

Dairy-free: Coconut milk, homemade tigernut milk

Drinks: Sobolo (no sugar), ginger, coconut water

Shops: Melcom, MaxMart, Shoprite, Makola market

Kenya

Flours: Pure wimbi (finger millet) or sorghum flour — check no maize is added

Dairy-free: Kara coconut milk, coconut cream

Drinks: Ginger-lemongrass “chai” without tea leaves

Shops: Naivas, Quickmart, Carrefour, Chandarana

South Africa

Dairy-free: Oh Mylk, Alpro, Rhodes coconut milk

Drinks: Freshpak Rooibos (naturally caffeine-free)

Pantry: Nature's Choice, Bob's Red Mill gluten-free

Shops: Woolworths, Checkers, Dis-Chem, Faithful to Nature

United Kingdom

Dairy-free: Koko, Alpro, The Coconut Collaborative, Violife

African foods: Tropical Sun yam, plantain & cassava flours

Sauces: Free & Easy

Shops: Tesco & Sainsbury's Free From, Holland & Barrett, African shops

USA & Canada

Flours: Otto's Naturals cassava flour, Bob's Red Mill gluten-free

Dairy-free: So Delicious, Cocojune, Daiya, Earth's Own

Snacks: Enjoy Life, MadeGood

Shops: Whole Foods, Loblaws (PC Free From), Thrive Market

YOUR NOTES

My notes

Favourite recipes, changes that worked, foods your child tried...

YOU DID IT

Thirty days of love

Thirty days. Ninety meals. Hundreds of small, brave choices — by you *and* your child.

Whatever changed this month — a better night's sleep, a calmer afternoon, one new food tried, one less tummy ache — it matters. Write it down. Celebrate it.

What next?

- Start again at Day 1 — it gets easier every round.
- Mark your family's favourite days and repeat them.
- Keep using your food & mood tracker from the Printables pack.
- Bring foods back one at a time, and watch closely.

Your bonus books

- **Healing Lunch Box** — 30 days of school lunches.
- **Healing Sips** — 30 gentle detox drinks.
- **Healing Printables** — trackers, cards & charts.
- **Healing Celebrations** — birthday cake & parties.

You are doing an amazing job. Your child is lucky to have you.

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

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Healing Lunch Box

BONUS BOOK 1

30 Days of Allergy-Free School Lunches & Snacks Kids Will Actually Eat



30 lunch boxes

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free | Processed sugar-free | Nut-free

Nut-free and school-safe.

BY

Tris Eliverson

WELCOME

A lunch box made with love



Dear Mama, dear Papa,

I know the feeling of packing a lunch box and wondering if it will come home untouched. I know the worry of sending your child to school with allergies, and the little ache when everyone else has biscuits and crisps.

These 30 lunch boxes are the ones that work in my home. They are safe, simple and fun — familiar Nigerian favourites next to nuggets, pinwheels and pizza bites that children are proud to open in front of their friends.

Every box is free from gluten, dairy, corn, eggs, caffeine, tuna, pork, processed sugar **and nuts**, so it is school-safe.

Pack it with love. That's the most important ingredient. ♥

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

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BEFORE YOU START

7 golden lunch box rules

A good lunch box is safe, simple and fun. Follow these 7 golden rules and lunchtime gets easier for everyone.

1. **Pack the night before**
   Mornings are busy. Pack everything except hot food the evening before.

2. **One safe food + one new food**
   Always include a food your child already loves. Put the new food beside it — no pressure.

3. **Keep it cold — or hot**
   Use an ice pack for cold boxes and a thermos for warm food like jollof or soup.

4. **Every box is nut-free**
   Most schools are nut-free. We use sunflower-seed butter instead of peanut butter.

5. **Tell the teacher**
   Give the school a copy of the allergy card from the Printables pack.

6. **Small and colourful wins**
   Small portions, bright colours and fun shapes. Cookie cutters are your best friend.

7. **Let them choose**
   Offer two choices: “Nuggets or pinwheels tomorrow?” Children eat what they choose.

FOR PICKY EATERS

The picky eater playbook

If your child eats only a few foods, you are not doing anything wrong. Many children — especially autistic children — feel safer with food that is predictable. These gentle tricks help.

1. Food chaining

Start from a food they love and change **one small thing** at a time:
shop nuggets → homemade nuggets → nuggets with paprika → chicken strips → chicken skewers.

2. Same food, new shape

Cut sandwiches, fruit and flatbread with cookie cutters. Stars, hearts and dinosaurs make the same food feel new.

3. The learning portion

Put one tiny piece of a new food in its own section. No need to eat it — just let it sit there. It can take 15 or more tries.

4. Respect the senses

Keep foods separate, offer dips, and notice what your child prefers: crunchy or soft, warm or cold, smooth or lumpy.

5. Let them help

Children eat what they choose, wash, pack or build. Offer two choices: “Pinwheels or nuggets tomorrow?”

6. Praise the try

Celebrate touching, smelling or licking a new food — not just eating it. Use the “I tried it!” chart in Healing Printables.

When to ask for extra help

If your child eats fewer than 20 foods, is losing weight, gags or vomits often, or mealtimes cause great distress, ask your doctor about a feeding therapist. You don't have to do this alone.

STOCK UP ONCE

Lunch box pantry list

Keep these in the kitchen and freezer and you can pack a safe lunch in minutes.

Batch-cook & freeze

- [ ] Chicken nuggets
- [ ] Mini meatballs
- [ ] Baked akara bites
- [ ] Mini moi moi cups
- [ ] Mama's chicken, potato & carrot soup
- [ ] Banana bread bites

Carbs

- [ ] Rice & rice pasta
- [ ] Cassava flour (for flatbreads)
- [ ] Easy Buckwheat Bread
- [ ] Sweet potatoes
- [ ] Ripe & green plantains
- [ ] Plain rice crackers (check: no corn)

Fruit

- [ ] Apples, bananas, grapes
- [ ] Mango, pineapple, watermelon
- [ ] Berries
- [ ] Oranges & tangerines

Vegetables

- [ ] Cucumber, carrots, peppers
- [ ] Cherry tomatoes
- [ ] Lettuce
- [ ] Peas & broccoli

Dips

- [ ] Coconut yogurt
- [ ] Hummus (contains sesame)
- [ ] Sunflower-seed butter
- [ ] Guacamole
- [ ] Sunshine Ketchup (no sugar)

Crunch

- [ ] Baked plantain chips (ipekere)
- [ ] Crunchy chickpeas
- [ ] Pumpkin & sunflower seeds
- [ ] Toasted coconut chips

Kit

- [ ] Bento box with sections
- [ ] Small thermos
- [ ] Ice pack
- [ ] Silicone cupcake cases
- [ ] Cookie cutters
- [ ] Paper straws & blunt picks

YOUR MONTH AT A GLANCE

30 lunch boxes

1 L Nugget happy box	**2** L Pizza pinwheels	**3** L Rainbow rice balls	**4** L Turkey roll-ups	**5** L Meatball skewers	**6** L Jollof thermos	**7** L DIY “lunchable”
8 L Mama's soup thermos	**9** L Moi moi & dodo	**10** L Rainbow pasta salad	**11** L Shawarma pinwheels	**12** L Fish finger box	**13** L Mama's pasta thermos	**14** L Akara bites & mango
15 L Fried rice thermos	**16** L Turkey sliders	**17** L Suya sticks & dodo	**18** L Mac bites box	**19** L Chicken potato salad	**20** L Pancakes for lunch	**21** L Beans & dodo thermos
22 L Rice paper rolls	**23** L Coconut curry thermos	**24** L Jollof spaghetti	**25** L Pizza wedges	**26** L Build-a-taco box	**27** L Coconut rice & fish	**28** L Hummus dippers
29 L Picnic box	**30** L Celebration box					

DAY 1 Chicken Nugget Happy Box

Prep the night before

YOU NEED

- [ ] 6 homemade chicken nuggets
- [ ] Handful of sweet potato wedges
- [ ] Apple slices + squeeze of lemon
- [ ] Cucumber sticks
- [ ] 2 tbsp Sunshine Ketchup

STEPS

1. Coat chicken pieces in olive oil, then cassava flour, paprika and salt.
2. Bake with the wedges at 220 °C / 425 °F for 15–18 min.
3. Sunshine Ketchup: simmer 1 cup passata, 2 chopped dates, pinch of salt and a splash of apple cider vinegar for 10 min; blend.
4. Morning: pack everything, ketchup in a little pot for dipping.

Why it helps: A homemade "happy meal" with no egg, no wheat and no added sugar.

Picky eater trick: Cut apple slices with a heart cookie cutter. Shapes make food fun.

DAY 2 Mini Pizza Pinwheels

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cassava flatbread or tortilla
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato passata + pinch oregano
- [ ] 2 tbsp dairy-free cheese, grated
- [ ] A few shreds of cooked chicken
- [ ] Grapes (halved for under-5s)
- [ ] Carrot sticks

STEPS

1. Spread passata over the flatbread. Sprinkle oregano, cheese and chicken.
2. Roll up tightly and slice into 6 rounds.
3. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 8 min — or pack cold.
4. Pack with the grapes and carrots.

Why it helps: All the pizza flavour kids love, in a fun swirl shape.

DAY 3 Rainbow Rice Ball Bento

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup cooked short-grain rice
- [ ] ½ cup shredded cooked chicken
- [ ] Pinch of salt
- [ ] Cucumber coins
- [ ] Strawberries & mango cubes
- [ ] Coconut yogurt dip

STEPS

1. Mix the warm rice with chicken and salt.
2. With wet hands, roll into 6 small balls.
3. Pack each food in its own section, sorted by colour.
4. Add the dip in a small pot.

Why it helps: Separate sections are perfect for children who don't like foods touching.

Fun idea: Ask your child to "eat the rainbow" — one bite of every colour.

DAY 4 Turkey & Avocado Roll-Ups

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cassava flatbread or tortilla
- [ ] ½ avocado, mashed
- [ ] 3 slices homemade roast turkey or chicken
- [ ] Lettuce leaf, grated carrot
- [ ] Blueberries
- [ ] Baked plantain chips

STEPS

1. Spread avocado over the flatbread.
2. Layer turkey, lettuce and carrot.
3. Roll tightly and cut into 2-bite pieces.
4. Pack with blueberries and plantain chips.

Why it helps: Homemade meat avoids the nitrates found in most deli slices.

DAY 5 Mini Meatball Skewers

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 250 g beef mince
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] 2 tbsp cassava flour
- [ ] 2 tbsp grated courgette (hidden veg!)
- [ ] ½ tsp garlic powder, salt
- [ ] Cherry tomatoes, cucumber
- [ ] Tomato dip

STEPS

1. Mix mince, flax egg, flour, courgette and seasoning.
2. Roll into 12 small balls.
3. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 15 min. Cool.
4. Thread onto paper straws or blunt picks with halved tomatoes and cucumber.

Why it helps: Food on a stick is fun — and the courgette is hidden inside.

Time saver: Make a double batch and freeze half for next week.

DAY 6 Jollof Rice & Chicken Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup leftover jollof rice
- [ ] 3–4 pieces baked chicken
- [ ] Watermelon cubes
- [ ] Carrot sticks

STEPS

1. Heat the jollof and chicken until piping hot in the morning.
2. Fill the thermos with boiling water for 5 min, empty it, then add the food — it stays warm until lunch.
3. Pack the watermelon and carrots separately.

Why it helps: A familiar home favourite makes lunchtime feel safe for sensitive eaters.

DAY 7 DIY “Lunchable” Box

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 6 plain rice crackers (check: no corn)
- [ ] 4 slices homemade roast chicken
- [ ] 6 cubes dairy-free cheese
- [ ] Cucumber coins, grapes
- [ ] 2 Sunshine Bliss Balls

STEPS

1. Bliss balls: blitz 1 cup dates, ½ cup sunflower seeds and 2 tbsp coconut; roll into balls.
2. Arrange crackers, chicken, cheese and cucumber in rows.
3. Add grapes and bliss balls.

Why it helps: Kids build their own “cracker stacks” — and feel in charge of their food.

Allergy note: Shop-bought lunch kits contain dairy, wheat and nitrates. This one is clean.

DAY 8 Mama's Soup Thermos

Author's family favourite
Use frozen soup

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 portion Mama's Chicken, Potato & Carrot Soup
- [ ] 2 slices buckwheat bread, cut into soldiers
- [ ] Cucumber sticks
- [ ] Apple slices + squeeze of lemon

STEPS

1. Heat the soup until piping hot.
2. Warm the thermos with boiling water for 5 min, empty, then fill with soup.
3. Pack the bread soldiers, cucumber and apple separately.

Why it helps: My child's favourite soup — all the vegetables blended in, so nothing to pick out.

Time saver: Freeze soup in single portions on Sunday. Lunch is ready all week.

DAY 9 Mini Moi Moi & Dodo Box

Prep ahead

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 egg-free mini moi moi cups (steamed in silicone cases)
- [ ] Handful baked dodo bites
- [ ] Cucumber coins
- [ ] Watermelon cubes

STEPS

1. Steam moi moi in silicone cases 35–40 min. Cool and refrigerate (or freeze).
2. Bake ripe plantain cubes in a little coconut oil at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min.
3. Pack moi moi, dodo, cucumber and watermelon in separate sections.

Why it helps: A taste of home — beans set perfectly without egg and are full of plant protein.

DAY 10 Rainbow Pasta Salad Pot

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup cooked rice pasta (cold)
- [ ] ½ cup cooked chicken, diced
- [ ] Cucumber, cherry tomatoes, pepper — diced
- [ ] 1 tbsp olive oil + squeeze of lemon + pinch of salt
- [ ] Grapes (halved for under-5s)

STEPS

1. Toss pasta, chicken and vegetables.
2. Stir through olive oil, lemon and salt.
3. Pack with a small pot of grapes.

Why it helps: Colourful, cold and easy to eat with a fork — no soggy bread.

DAY 11 Chicken Shawarma Pinwheels

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cassava flatbread
- [ ] ½ cup cooked shawarma-spiced chicken, sliced
- [ ] 1 tbsp garlic coconut yogurt sauce
- [ ] Lettuce, grated carrot
- [ ] Orange segments

STEPS

1. Spread the yogurt sauce over the flatbread.
2. Add chicken, lettuce and carrot.
3. Roll tightly and slice into 6 pinwheels.
4. Pack with orange segments.

Why it helps: A Naija favourite in a fun swirl — no wheat wrap, no mayonnaise.

DAY 12 Fish Finger Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 baked fish fingers (cassava crumb)
- [ ] 2 tbsp minty pea dip (peas blended with olive oil)
- [ ] Carrot sticks
- [ ] Grapes

STEPS

1. Bake extra fish fingers at dinner and chill.
2. Blend cooked peas with olive oil, mint and salt for the dip.
3. Pack everything with the dip in a little pot.

Why it helps: White fish is gentle, low in mercury and great cold or warm.

DAY 13 Mama's Pasta Thermos

Author's family favourite
Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 portion Mama's Pasta with Meat & Tomato Sauce
- [ ] Cucumber sticks
- [ ] Banana

STEPS

1. Heat the pasta and sauce until piping hot.
2. Warm the thermos with boiling water, empty, then fill.
3. Pack cucumber and a banana.

Why it helps: A dinner my child asks for again and again — just as good at lunchtime.

DAY 14 Akara Bites & Mango Box

Prep ahead

YOU NEED

- [ ] 5 baked akara bites
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato dip
- [ ] Mango cubes
- [ ] Cucumber sticks

STEPS

1. Bake akara bites in a mini muffin tin (see Naija Snack Corner). Cool.
2. Pack with the tomato dip, mango and cucumber.

Why it helps: Akara is naturally gluten-free and egg-free — and baked, not fried.

DAY 15 Rainbow Fried Rice Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup chicken fried rice (no sweetcorn)
- [ ] Extra peas & diced carrot
- [ ] Pineapple chunks

STEPS

1. Reheat the fried rice with a splash of water until steaming.
2. Fill a pre-warmed thermos.
3. Pack pineapple separately.

Why it helps: Shop fried rice often has sweetcorn and soy sauce — this one has neither.

DAY 16 Mini Turkey Burger Sliders

Prep ahead

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 mini turkey burgers (cooked & chilled)
- [ ] 2 small rounds of buckwheat bread or lettuce “buns”
- [ ] Cucumber slices
- [ ] Sweet potato fries (baked)
- [ ] Sunshine Ketchup

STEPS

1. Make mini burgers with the turkey burger recipe in Healing Plates.
2. Sandwich each in bread rounds or lettuce leaves.
3. Pack with fries, cucumber and a dip.

Why it helps: Kids feel grown-up with a mini burger — and it's completely safe.

DAY 17 Chicken Suya Sticks & Dodo

Prep ahead

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 nut-free chicken suya sticks (mild)
- [ ] Baked dodo bites
- [ ] Sliced cucumber & tomato
- [ ] Tangerine

STEPS

1. Rub chicken strips with ginger, paprika, garlic and onion powder (no groundnut, little pepper).
2. Bake at 220 °C / 425 °F for 12–15 min. Cool.
3. Pack with dodo, salad and fruit.

Why it helps: All the suya flavour, without the groundnut — school-safe.

DAY 18 Butternut Mac Bites Box

Prep ahead

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 butternut mac bites
- [ ] Steamed broccoli florets
- [ ] Apple slices
- [ ] Coconut yogurt dip

STEPS

1. Spoon leftover butternut “mac & cheese” into a muffin tin.
2. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 15 min until set.
3. Cool, then pack with broccoli, apple and dip.

Why it helps: Golden, cheesy-tasting bites with squash hidden inside.

DAY 19 Roast Chicken & Potato Salad Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] Leftover roast chicken pieces
- [ ] ½ cup cooked potatoes, cubed
- [ ] 2 tbsp coconut yogurt + chives + lemon
- [ ] Peas, cherry tomatoes
- [ ] Grapes

STEPS

1. Mix potatoes with coconut yogurt, chives, lemon and salt.
2. Add peas.
3. Pack with chicken, tomatoes and grapes.

Why it helps: Creamy potato salad with no egg mayonnaise.

DAY 20 Pancakes-for-Lunch Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 mini banana buckwheat pancakes
- [ ] Small pot of coconut yogurt
- [ ] Berries
- [ ] 1 tbsp sunflower-seed butter (dip)

STEPS

1. Make extra pancakes at breakfast and cool.
2. Pack with yogurt, berries and the seed-butter dip.

Why it helps: Breakfast-for-lunch feels like a treat — and it's still a balanced meal.

DAY 21 Beans & Dodo Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 portion beans & ripe plantain porridge
- [ ] Cucumber sticks
- [ ] Orange segments

STEPS

1. Reheat the beans until steaming.
2. Fill a pre-warmed thermos.
3. Pack cucumber and orange separately.

Why it helps: Honey beans are naturally sweet and full of fibre — filling all afternoon.

DAY 22 Rainbow Rice Paper Rolls

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 rice paper sheets
- [ ] Cooked chicken strips
- [ ] Cucumber, carrot, pepper — thin sticks
- [ ] Lettuce, mango strips
- [ ] Coconut aminos dip

STEPS

1. Dip a rice paper sheet in warm water for 10 seconds.
2. Fill with chicken, vegetables and mango.
3. Fold the sides in and roll tightly.
4. Pack with a little pot of coconut aminos.

Why it helps: See-through rolls let children see exactly what's inside — no surprises.

Allergy note: Check the rice paper label: rice, tapioca, salt and water only.

DAY 23 Coconut Chicken Curry Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 portion mild coconut chicken curry
- [ ] ½ cup rice
- [ ] Cucumber coins
- [ ] Mango

STEPS

1. Reheat the curry and rice until piping hot.
2. Fill a pre-warmed thermos.
3. Pack cucumber and mango.

Why it helps: Mild, creamy and warming — turmeric and ginger are gentle on tummies.

DAY 24 Jollof Spaghetti Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 portion jollof spaghetti with chicken
- [ ] Carrot sticks
- [ ] Watermelon

STEPS

1. Reheat until steaming.
2. Fill a pre-warmed thermos.
3. Pack carrot sticks and watermelon.

Why it helps: Jollof + pasta = a lunch box that always comes home empty.

DAY 25 Pizza Quesadilla Wedges

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cassava flatbread
- [ ] 2 tbsp passata + pinch oregano
- [ ] 2 tbsp dairy-free cheese
- [ ] Cooked chicken, chopped
- [ ] Cherry tomatoes, grapes

STEPS

1. Spread passata on half the flatbread. Add cheese and chicken.
2. Fold over and toast in a dry pan 2 min each side.
3. Cool and cut into 4 wedges.
4. Pack with tomatoes and grapes.

Why it helps: Pizza flavour in a crispy wedge — easy to hold and eat.

DAY 26 Build-a-Taco Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 small cassava flatbreads
- [ ] Taco-spiced beef mince (cold or in thermos)
- [ ] Shredded lettuce, diced tomato
- [ ] 2 tbsp guacamole
- [ ] Dairy-free cheese, grated

STEPS

1. Pack each filling in its own section.
2. Add the flatbreads folded in half.
3. Your child builds their own tacos at lunch.

Why it helps: Building their own lunch gives children control — and they eat more.

DAY 27 Coconut Rice & Fish Bites

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup coconut rice
- [ ] 4 baked fish bites (white fish, cassava crumb)
- [ ] Cucumber & tomato salad
- [ ] Pineapple

STEPS

1. Cut fish into bites, coat and bake at 220 °C / 425 °F for 10 min.
2. Pack rice and fish bites.
3. Add salad and pineapple.

Why it helps: Coconut rice makes fish feel like a party.

DAY 28 Hummus Dipper Box

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 tbsp hummus
- [ ] Cucumber, carrot & pepper sticks
- [ ] 6 plain rice crackers (no corn)
- [ ] Cooked chicken pieces
- [ ] Grapes

STEPS

1. Spoon hummus into a small pot.
2. Arrange vegetables, crackers and chicken around it.
3. Add grapes.

Why it helps: Dipping makes vegetables fun — even for veggie-shy children.

Allergy note: Hummus contains sesame. If sesame is a problem, use guacamole instead.

DAY 29 Picnic Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 chicken skewers (cold)
- [ ] Egg-free potato salad
- [ ] Rainbow fruit kebab on a paper straw
- [ ] Plantain chips

STEPS

1. Pack the skewers and potato salad.
2. Thread fruit onto a paper straw.
3. Add a handful of plantain chips.

Why it helps: A little picnic in a box — perfect for sunny days and school trips.

DAY 30 Day 30 Celebration Box

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] Mini portion of party jollof
- [ ] Baked chicken piece
- [ ] Baked dodo
- [ ] 1 banana bread bite
- [ ] A note: “You did it! 30 days!”

STEPS

1. Pack the jollof, chicken and dodo.
2. Add a banana bread bite as a treat.
3. Tuck in a little note or sticker to celebrate.

Why it helps: Thirty days of safe, happy lunches — that's worth celebrating!

SNACK ATTACK

10 snacks kids can't say no to

Bright, crunchy, dippable and fun. These snacks are made for even the pickiest eaters — nut-free, processed-sugar-free and free from every food in this book.

1. Veggie Tots

Mash 1 sweet potato with ½ grated courgette and 3 tbsp tapioca flour. Shape into little logs, bake 20 min at 200 °C.

2. Fruit Nachos

Thin apple slices on a plate, drizzled with warm sunflower-seed butter and carob syrup. Sprinkle coconut.

3. Banana Sushi

Spread coconut yogurt on a banana, roll in crushed pumpkin seeds, slice into "sushi" rounds.

4. Frozen Yogurt Bark

Spread coconut yogurt on parchment, dot with berries, freeze 3 hours and snap into pieces.

5. Apple "Donuts"

Slice apples into rings, core them, spread with sunflower-seed butter and add coconut "sprinkles".

6. Baked Plantain Chips

Very thin green plantain slices, olive oil and salt. Bake 15–20 min at 190 °C until crisp.

7. Crunchy Chickpeas

Dry a tin of chickpeas, toss with oil, paprika and salt. Bake 30 min at 200 °C.

8. Sunshine Bliss Balls

Blitz dates, sunflower seeds and coconut. Roll into balls. No nuts, no sugar added.

9. Pancake Skewers

Leftover mini pancakes and strawberries threaded onto paper straws.

10. Cucumber Pizza Coins

Thick cucumber rounds topped with a dab of hummus and chopped tomato.

Carob instead of chocolate

Chocolate and cocoa contain caffeine. Carob tastes chocolatey, is naturally sweet and caffeine-free.

TASTE OF HOME

Naija snack corner

Our favourite Nigerian snacks — made gluten-free, egg-free, nut-free, processed-sugar-free and baked instead of deep-fried. Familiar tastes from home that are safe for school.

1. Ipekere (Plantain Chips)

Thin green plantain slices, a little oil and salt. Bake 15–20 min at 190 °C until crisp.

2. Baked Dodo Bites

Ripe plantain cubes tossed in a little coconut oil. Bake 20 min at 200 °C, turning once.

3. Cassava Chin Chin

Crunchy, egg-free and wheat-free — baked, not fried. Full recipe over the page.

4. Baked Akara Bites

Fluffy bean balls baked in a mini muffin tin. Full recipe over the page.

5. Mini Moi Moi Cups

Egg-free moi moi steamed in silicone cupcake cases — the perfect lunch box size.

6. Nut-Free Chicken Suya Sticks

Chicken strips rubbed with ginger, paprika, garlic and onion powder (no groundnut). Bake 15 min at 220 °C.

7. Gizdodo Bites

Cooked gizzard and ripe plantain cubes in a light pepper sauce. Pack in a small thermos.

8. Dundun Fries

Yam sticks tossed in oil and salt, baked 25 min at 200 °C. Crispy outside, soft inside.

9. Ofio & Coconut Mix

Soaked tiger nuts with toasted coconut chips. Tiger nuts are tubers, not nuts — school-safe.

10. Zobo Ice Pops

Hibiscus zobo with pineapple and ginger, sweetened with dates. Freeze in moulds — no sugar, no caffeine.

Watch out for

Shop-bought chin chin, puff-puff, meat pie and doughnuts (wheat & egg), kokoro and popcorn (corn), and kuli kuli (groundnut).

NAIJA SNACK

Crunchy Cassava Chin Chin

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups cassava flour
- [ ] 3 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] ½ tsp ground nutmeg, pinch of salt
- [ ] ⅓ cup solid coconut oil
- [ ] About ⅓ cup coconut milk

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line 2 trays with parchment.
2. Mix flour, nutmeg and salt. Rub in the coconut oil with your fingers.
3. Add the maple syrup, then coconut milk a little at a time, to make a firm dough.
4. Roll out 5 mm thick and cut into small squares.
5. Bake 15–20 min, stirring once, until golden. They crisp as they cool.

Why it helps: The chin chin every Nigerian child knows — with no wheat, no egg, no processed sugar and no deep frying.

Picky eater trick: Let your child cut the squares with a blunt knife. Kids eat what they make.

NAIJA SNACK

Baked Akara Bites

35 min + soaking

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups black-eyed beans, soaked & peeled
- [ ] 1 small onion
- [ ] ½ scotch bonnet (skip for young kids)
- [ ] ½ tsp salt
- [ ] 2–3 tbsp water
- [ ] Olive oil, for the tin

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 200 °C / 400 °F. Oil a mini muffin tin well.
2. Blend beans, onion, pepper and salt with very little water to a thick paste.
3. Whisk hard for 3 min until light and fluffy.
4. Spoon into the tin and bake 20–25 min until golden.
5. Cool and pack with a tomato dip.

Why it helps: Akara is naturally gluten-free and egg-free — full of plant protein.

Time saver: Bake a big batch on Sunday and freeze. Warm for 5 min before packing.

YOU DID IT

Thirty happy lunches

Thirty lunch boxes. Thirty days of your child eating safely at school — and maybe even trying something new.

Keep it going

- Start again at Day 1 — or repeat the family favourites.
- Swap any box for a leftover dinner from Healing Plates.
- Keep a stash of frozen nuggets, akara and soup for busy weeks.

Don't forget

- Give the school a copy of the allergy card (Healing Printables).
- Check labels every time — recipes change.
- Celebrate every new food tried.

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

© Tris Eliverson. All rights reserved. For personal use only — please do not share or resell. This book shares food ideas from personal experience and is not medical advice. Always check food labels and your school's food policy. Cut grapes, cherry tomatoes and other round foods lengthways for children under 5.

Healing Sips

BONUS BOOK 2

The 30-Day Gentle Detox & Juicing Plan for the Whole Family



30 detox recipes

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free | Processed sugar-free

One gentle glass a day.

BY

Tris Eliverson

WELCOME

One gentle glass a day



Dear Mama, dear Papa,

When I started my child's healing journey, one of the simplest things I did was add **one gentle drink a day**. A green smoothie in the morning. A calming cup of lemon balm before bed. Slowly, gently, things began to shift — and I saw a real, significant improvement in my child.

This book holds those drinks: my own daily detox smoothie first, then 29 more juices, smoothies and tonics for the whole family. Each one tells you what it is good for, so you can choose the right glass for the day.

Please go slowly. Detox is not about doing more — it's about doing a little, every day, with love.

One gentle glass a day. ♥

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

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BEFORE YOU START

The gentle way to detox

Detox should be gentle. Our bodies — especially little bodies — clean themselves best when we go slowly and support them every day.

Go slowly

- Children start with ¼–½ cup. Adults, 1 cup.
- One new drink at a time.
- Tummy ache, rash, poor sleep or crankiness? Use less and go slower.

Every day

- Drink plenty of water.
- Add seeds for fibre: chia, flax, pumpkin, sunflower, psyllium.
- Bounce on a trampoline or dance — it moves the lymph system.
- Lemon balm 2 hours before bed for better sleep.

Keep it fresh

- Wash fruit and vegetables well — pesticides are something we reduce.
- Drink juices within 30 minutes of making them.
- Use glass or stainless-steel cups.

Safety first

- No honey for babies under 1 year.
- Ask your doctor before herbs or supplements, especially with medication, pregnancy or breastfeeding.
- Sea moss is rich in iodine — check first if there is a thyroid condition.

Smoothie or juice?

Smoothies keep the fibre — more filling and great for bowels. **Juices** remove the fibre — lighter and quickly absorbed. No juicer? Blend, then strain through a clean cloth or sieve.

KNOW YOUR INGREDIENTS

What's in your glass

Know what's in your glass. Mix and match these to make your own healing drinks.

Ingredient	Good for
Celery	Digestion, hydration — the foundation of my daily detox
Green apple	Fibre that helps bind and carry out waste
Coriander & parsley	Traditional cleansing herbs
Blueberries	Antioxidants for the brain
Ginger	Calms nausea and settles the tummy
Lemon & lime	Vitamin C, freshness, liver support
Beetroot	Liver support and healthy blood flow
Cucumber & watermelon	Hydration and easy bowels
Pineapple & pawpaw	Natural enzymes that help digestion
Turmeric	Calms inflammation
Chia, flax & psyllium	Gentle fibre for regular bowels
Broccoli sprouts	Sulforaphane — top of my greens list
Moringa & ugu	Iron, calcium and energy
Baobab	Vitamin C and fibre that feeds good gut bacteria
Spirulina	Iron and protein; I use it for mould and yeast support
Sea moss	Minerals for gut and skin (rich in iodine — see safety)
Black seed oil	Gut and immunity (age 3+, 3 times a week)
Lemon balm	Sleep and calm — naturally caffeine-free

GET READY

Detox pantry & kit

Stock these once and you can make any drink in this book.

Kit

- [ ] Blender
- [ ] Fine sieve or nut-milk bag (for juices)
- [ ] Glass jars & bottles
- [ ] Ice-cube trays (freeze leftovers)
- [ ] Glass or stainless-steel cups
- [ ] Paper straws

Fresh every week

- [ ] Celery, cucumber, spinach, kale
- [ ] Green apples, lemons, limes
- [ ] Ginger, fresh mint
- [ ] Coriander & parsley
- [ ] Seasonal fruit: pineapple, mango, pawpaw, watermelon, oranges

Freezer

- [ ] Frozen mango & pineapple
- [ ] Frozen berries & blueberries
- [ ] Sliced ripe bananas

Pantry

- [ ] Chia & ground flaxseed
- [ ] Dried hibiscus (zobo)
- [ ] Tiger nuts
- [ ] Dates
- [ ] Coconut water
- [ ] Coconut milk
- [ ] Rooibos tea
- [ ] Dried lemon balm

Powders & extras

- [ ] Spirulina
- [ ] Lion's mane
- [ ] Moringa
- [ ] Baobab
- [ ] Turmeric
- [ ] Sea moss (dried or gel)
- [ ] Black seed oil
- [ ] Raw honey or pure maple syrup

How to make sea moss gel

Rinse 30 g dried sea moss very well. Soak in fresh water for 12–24 hours until soft. Rinse again, then blend with 1 cup fresh water until smooth. Store in a glass jar in the fridge for up to 2 weeks. Children: 1 tsp a day; adults: 1 tbsp.

YOUR MONTH AT A GLANCE

30 healing sips

1 S Daily Detox Smoothie	**2** S Boosted Detox Smoothie	**3** S Sea moss gut soother	**4** S Lemon balm bedtime tea	**5** S Morning celery juice	**6** S Watermelon cucumber cooler	**7** S Broccoli sprout mango
8 S Beet, carrot & apple	**9** S Pineapple-ginger soother	**10** S Zobo cooler	**11** S Ugu & pineapple juice	**12** S Moringa mango	**13** S Pawpaw lime	**14** S Golden turmeric milk
15 S Kiwi spinach apple	**16** S Baobab berry	**17** S Tiger nut milk	**18** S Carrot orange ginger	**19** S Cucumber mint water	**20** S Apple celery parsley	**21** S Coconut water refresher
22 S Blueberry brain smoothie	**23** S Beet & berry	**24** S Chia lemonade	**25** S Avocado kale pear	**26** S Ginger-lemon tonic	**27** S Rooibos iced tea	**28** S Pineapple coriander
29 S Prune & pear	**30** S Rainbow celebration					

DAY 1 The Daily Detox Smoothie

Author's recipe
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 celery stick
- [ ] ½ green apple
- [ ] Handful of blueberries
- [ ] 1 tbsp fresh coriander (cilantro)
- [ ] 1 tbsp fresh parsley
- [ ] 1 cup water (or more)

STEPS

1. Wash everything well.
2. Blend until smooth.
3. Drink fresh, in the morning.

Gentle daily cleanse · Bowels · Hydration · Antioxidants

Why it helps: Celery is the foundation. Apple adds binding fibre. Coriander and parsley are traditional cleansing herbs.

Go slowly: Children: start with half a cup. Detox should be slow and gentle.

DAY 2 Boosted Detox Smoothie

Author's recipe
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] Everything from Day 1
- [ ] ¼ tsp spirulina powder
- [ ] ¼ tsp lion's mane powder
- [ ] Brahmi (bacopa) — adults only

STEPS

1. Make the Day 1 smoothie.
2. Add the spirulina and lion's mane.
3. Blend again and drink fresh.

Brain & focus · Mould & yeast support · Energy

Why it helps: Spirulina is rich in iron and protein. Lion's mane is a mushroom traditionally used for focus.

Safety first: Ask your child's doctor before adding any herb or supplement, especially with medication.

DAY 3 Sea Moss & Black Seed Gut Soother

Author's recipe
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 tsp sea moss gel (children) or 1 tbsp (adults)
- [ ] 1 ripe banana
- [ ] ½ cup pineapple
- [ ] 1 cup coconut water
- [ ] ½ tsp black seed oil (age 3+, 3 times a week)

STEPS

1. Blend everything until creamy.
2. Drink straight away.
3. Use black seed oil only 3 times a week.

Gut · Skin & eczema · Immunity

Why it helps: Sea moss and black seed oil are my go-to pair for gut troubles.

Safety first: Sea moss is rich in iodine. If there's a thyroid condition, ask your doctor first.

DAY 4 Lemon Balm Bedtime Tea

Author's recipe
10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 tbsp dried lemon balm (or 6 fresh leaves)
- [ ] 1 cup hot water
- [ ] Slice of lemon
- [ ] 1 tsp honey (optional — not under age 1)

STEPS

1. Pour hot water over the lemon balm.
2. Cover and steep 5–7 min, then strain.
3. Cool until warm. Add lemon and honey.
4. Drink about 2 hours before bedtime.

Sleep · Calm · Tummy

Why it helps: Lemon balm is my favourite herb for sleep — calming and naturally caffeine-free.

DAY 5 Morning Celery Juice

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 bunch celery (makes about 1 cup)
- [ ] ½ green apple (optional, for children)

STEPS

1. Wash the celery well and chop.
2. Juice — or blend with ¼ cup water and strain.
3. Drink on an empty stomach, 15–30 min before breakfast.

Digestion · Hydration · Liver support

Why it helps: Celery is the foundation of my daily detox.

Go slowly: Children: start with ¼ cup mixed with apple. Build up slowly.

DAY 6 Watermelon Cucumber Cooler

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups watermelon, cubed
- [ ] ½ cucumber
- [ ] 4 fresh mint leaves
- [ ] Squeeze of lime

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Strain if you like it smooth.
3. Serve over ice.

Constipation · Hydration · Kidneys

Why it helps: Watermelon and cucumber are on my constipation list — full of water and gentle fibre.

DAY 7 Broccoli Sprout Mango Smoothie

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] Small handful of broccoli sprouts
- [ ] 1 cup mango, fresh or frozen
- [ ] ½ ripe banana
- [ ] 1 cup coconut water
- [ ] Squeeze of lime

STEPS

1. Rinse the sprouts well.
2. Blend everything until smooth.
3. Drink fresh.

Antioxidants · Brain support · Cell repair

Why it helps: Broccoli sprouts are top of my greens list. Mango hides the green taste.

Fun idea: Grow your own: soak broccoli seeds in a jar, rinse twice a day — ready in 5 days.

DAY 8 Beet, Carrot & Apple Juice

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 small beetroot, peeled
- [ ] 2 carrots
- [ ] 1 green apple
- [ ] ½ lemon, peeled
- [ ] Small piece of ginger

STEPS

1. Wash and chop everything.
2. Juice — or blend with ½ cup water and strain.
3. Drink fresh.

Liver support · Healthy blood · Energy

Why it helps: A sweet, bright red juice that children love — beetroot supports the liver.

Good to know: Beetroot can turn wee and poo pink. That's normal!

DAY 9 Pineapple-Ginger Tummy Soother

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup pineapple
- [ ] ½ cucumber
- [ ] Small piece of ginger
- [ ] ½ cup coconut water
- [ ] Few mint leaves

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Strain if you like it smooth.
3. Serve cool.

Digestion · Bloating · Nausea

Why it helps: Pineapple has natural enzymes and ginger calms the tummy.

DAY 10 Zobo Cooler (No Sugar)

20 min + chilling

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup dried hibiscus (zobo) leaves
- [ ] 6 cups water
- [ ] Thumb of ginger, 4 cloves
- [ ] Pineapple peel (from 1 pineapple)
- [ ] 4–6 dates (to sweeten)

STEPS

1. Rinse zobo. Boil with ginger, cloves and pineapple peel for 15 min.
2. Add dates, turn off heat, steep 30 min.
3. Strain well and chill.

Antioxidants · Hydration · Vitamin C

Why it helps: Our favourite Naija drink, made without sugar — naturally caffeine-free.

Safety first: Hibiscus is not recommended in pregnancy. Ask your doctor if you take blood-pressure medicine.

DAY 11 Ugu & Pineapple Green Juice

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 big handful ugu (pumpkin leaves) or spinach
- [ ] 1½ cups pineapple
- [ ] ½ cucumber
- [ ] ½ lime
- [ ] ½ cup water

STEPS

1. Wash the ugu very well.
2. Blend everything, then strain through a cloth.
3. Drink fresh.

Iron · Blood building · Energy

Why it helps: Ugu is one of the richest local sources of iron. Pineapple makes it sweet.

DAY 12 Moringa Mango Smoothie

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup frozen mango
- [ ] ½ banana
- [ ] ½ tsp moringa powder
- [ ] 1 cup coconut water
- [ ] Squeeze of lime

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Drink fresh.

Iron & calcium · Energy · Immunity

Why it helps: Moringa is an African superfood leaf packed with minerals.

Go slowly: Start with ¼ tsp moringa for children — it has a strong taste.

DAY 13 Pawpaw Lime Smoothie

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1½ cups ripe pawpaw (papaya)
- [ ] ½ banana
- [ ] Juice of ½ lime
- [ ] ½ cup coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tsp chia seeds

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Drink straight away.

Digestion · Constipation · Skin

Why it helps: Pawpaw contains papain, a natural enzyme that helps break down food.

DAY 14 Golden Turmeric Milk (Warm)

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk (or ½ coconut milk, ½ water)
- [ ] ½ tsp turmeric
- [ ] Pinch of cinnamon & ginger
- [ ] Pinch of black pepper
- [ ] 1 tsp honey or maple (optional)

STEPS

1. Warm everything in a small pan, whisking, for 5 min — do not boil.
2. Cool until warm and drink before bed.

Calm · Sleep · Inflammation

Why it helps: A cosy bedtime drink. Black pepper helps the body absorb turmeric.

DAY 15 Kiwi, Spinach & Apple Smoothie

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 kiwis, peeled
- [ ] 1 handful spinach
- [ ] 1 green apple
- [ ] 1 cup water or coconut water
- [ ] 1 tsp ground flaxseed

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Drink fresh.

Vitamin C · Immunity · Bowels

Why it helps: Kiwi is one of the best natural helpers for regular bowels.

DAY 16 Baobab Berry Smoothie

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup mixed berries
- [ ] ½ banana
- [ ] 1 tsp baobab powder
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] Few ice cubes

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Drink fresh.

Vitamin C · Good gut bacteria · Energy

Why it helps: Baobab, the African "tree of life" fruit, is rich in prebiotic fibre.

DAY 17 Tiger Nut Milk (Kunu Aya)

15 min + soaking

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup tiger nuts, soaked overnight
- [ ] 3 cups water
- [ ] 3–4 dates
- [ ] Small piece of ginger
- [ ] Pinch of cinnamon

STEPS

1. Drain the soaked tiger nuts.
2. Blend with water, dates, ginger and cinnamon until smooth.
3. Strain through a cloth. Chill and drink within 2 days.

Good gut bacteria · Dairy-free energy · Digestion

Why it helps: Tiger nuts are tubers, not nuts — a creamy, naturally sweet, school-safe milk.

DAY 18 Carrot, Orange & Ginger Juice

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 carrots
- [ ] 2 oranges, peeled
- [ ] Small piece of ginger
- [ ] Pinch of turmeric (optional)

STEPS

1. Juice everything — or blend with ½ cup water and strain.
2. Drink fresh.

Immunity · Skin · Eyes

Why it helps: Full of beta-carotene and vitamin C — a sunshine drink for winter colds.

DAY 19 Cucumber, Mint & Lime Water

5 min + chilling

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ cucumber, sliced
- [ ] Handful fresh mint
- [ ] 1 lime, sliced
- [ ] 1 litre water

STEPS

1. Put everything in a jug.
2. Chill for at least 1 hour.
3. Top up with water through the day.

Hydration · Kidneys · Fresh breath

Why it helps: Children who don't like plain water often love “spa water”.

DAY 20 Green Apple, Celery & Parsley Juice

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 green apples
- [ ] 3 celery sticks
- [ ] Handful fresh parsley
- [ ] ½ lemon, peeled

STEPS

1. Juice — or blend with ½ cup water and strain.
2. Drink fresh, before breakfast.

Kidneys · Gentle cleanse · Digestion

Why it helps: Parsley is one of my traditional cleansing herbs. Apple keeps it sweet.

DAY 21 Coconut Water Refresher

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup coconut water
- [ ] ½ cup fresh orange juice
- [ ] Squeeze of lime
- [ ] Tiny pinch of sea salt

STEPS

1. Stir everything together.
2. Serve cool.

Hydration · Electrolytes · After illness

Why it helps: A natural sports drink — perfect after a tummy bug or a hot day.

DAY 22 Blueberry Banana Brain Smoothie

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup blueberries (wild if you can)
- [ ] 1 ripe banana
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground flaxseed
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] ¼ tsp lion's mane (optional)

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Drink fresh.

Brain · Antioxidants · Focus

Why it helps: Wild blueberries are one of my top foods for the brain.

DAY 23 Red Beet & Berry Smoothie

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 small cooked beetroot
- [ ] 1 cup strawberries
- [ ] ½ banana
- [ ] 1 cup coconut water
- [ ] Squeeze of lemon

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Drink fresh.

Circulation · Stamina · Liver support

Why it helps: The berries hide the earthy beet taste — a bright pink treat.

DAY 24 Chia Lemonade

5 min + 10 min resting

YOU NEED

- [ ] Juice of 2 lemons
- [ ] 2 cups water
- [ ] 1 tbsp chia seeds
- [ ] 1–2 tsp honey or maple syrup

STEPS

1. Stir lemon, water and honey together.
2. Add chia and stir again.
3. Rest 10 min until the seeds swell.

Bowels · Hydration · Vitamin C

Why it helps: Chia seeds are my top tip for constipation — and children love the “bubbles”.

DAY 25 Avocado, Kale & Pear Smoothie

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ avocado
- [ ] 1 handful kale (stems removed)
- [ ] 1 ripe pear
- [ ] 1 cup coconut water
- [ ] Squeeze of lime

STEPS

1. Blend everything until creamy.
2. Drink fresh.

Healthy fats · Liver support · Fibre

Why it helps: Creamy and filling — a meal in a glass for busy mornings.

DAY 26 Warm Ginger-Lemon Tonic

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup hot water
- [ ] 3 thin slices fresh ginger
- [ ] Juice of ½ lemon
- [ ] 1 tsp raw honey (age 1+)

STEPS

1. Steep ginger in hot water for 5 min.
2. Add lemon and honey.
3. Cool until warm and sip slowly.

Immunity · Nausea · Colds

Why it helps: The first thing to make when someone feels unwell.

Kid tip: Use only 1 slice of ginger for young children.

DAY 27 Rooibos Orange Iced Tea

10 min + chilling

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 rooibos tea bags
- [ ] 2 cups hot water
- [ ] 1 orange, sliced
- [ ] Few mint leaves
- [ ] 1 tsp honey (optional)

STEPS

1. Steep rooibos in hot water for 5 min.
2. Add orange, mint and honey.
3. Chill and serve over ice.

Calm · Antioxidants · Skin & eczema

Why it helps: Rooibos from South Africa is naturally caffeine-free — a safe “tea” for children.

DAY 28 Pineapple Coriander Cleanse Juice

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1½ cups pineapple
- [ ] Handful fresh coriander
- [ ] ½ cucumber
- [ ] Juice of ½ lime
- [ ] ½ cup water

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Strain if you like.
3. Drink fresh.

Gentle cleanse · Digestion · Hydration

Why it helps: Coriander is one of my favourite cleansing herbs — pineapple makes it delicious.

DAY 29 Prune & Pear Smoothie

5 min + soaking

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 prunes, soaked in warm water 10 min
- [ ] 1 ripe pear
- [ ] ½ banana
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tsp chia seeds

STEPS

1. Blend everything (with the soaking water) until smooth.
2. Drink in the morning.

Constipation · Fibre · Gut

Why it helps: Prunes and pears are gentle, natural helpers for stuck tummies.

DAY 30 Rainbow Celebration Smoothie

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] Layer 1: 1 cup mango blended with coconut water
- [ ] Layer 2: 1 cup strawberries blended with banana
- [ ] Layer 3: 1 kiwi + handful spinach blended with apple
- [ ] Clear glasses, paper straws

STEPS

1. Blend each layer separately.
2. Pour slowly into glasses, one layer at a time.
3. Serve with a straw and a big cheer!

Celebration · Vitamins · Fun

Why it helps: Thirty days of gentle healing — time to celebrate with a rainbow!

PRINTABLE

30-day sip tracker

Write down each drink and how your child felt. Look back after a week — patterns jump out.

Day	Drink	Amount	Sleep · tummy · mood	Notes
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				
15				
16				
17				
18				
19				
20				
21				
22				
23				
24				
25				
26				
27				
28				
29				
30				

YOU DID IT

Thirty days of gentle healing

Thirty gentle glasses. Thirty small acts of love for your child's body.

What next?

- Keep your family's favourite drinks in the weekly routine.
- Return to the Daily Detox Smoothie as your everyday base.
- Look back at your tracker — what changed?

Remember

- Slow and steady is the healing way.
- Always check with your doctor before herbs and supplements.
- Water is still the best drink of all.

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

© Tris Eliverson. All rights reserved. For personal use only — please do not share or resell. This book shares recipes and ideas from personal experience and is not medical advice. Juices and herbs can interact with medicines. Always ask a qualified health professional before giving herbs or supplements to children, or if you are pregnant or breastfeeding. No honey for babies under 1 year.

Healing Printables

BONUS BOOK 3

Allergy cards, trackers, charts & planners to make every day easier



12 pages to print

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free | Processed sugar-free

Print. Stick on the fridge. Breathe.

BY

Tris Eliverson

START HERE

How to use your printables

These pages are made to be printed, stuck on the fridge, slipped into a school bag and scribbled on. Use them every day — they make the healing journey easier to follow and easier to share.

Printing tips

- Print on A4 or US Letter — choose “Fit to page”.
- Print the trackers and planners as many times as you need.
- Thicker paper or card works best for allergy cards.

Make them last

- Laminate the cheat sheet and planners, or slip them into plastic sleeves.
- Use a dry-wipe pen and reuse them every week.
- Keep allergy cards in the school bag, car and your purse.

Share them

Give a copy of the allergy card and the safe-foods list to teachers, nannies, grandparents and anyone who feeds your child. The more people who know, the safer your child is.

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PRINTABLE 1

Allergy cards

Print, cut out and give one to the teacher, nanny, grandparents or party host.

MY ALLERGY CARD

My name: _____

I cannot eat: ☐ Gluten (wheat) ☐ Dairy (milk) ☐ Corn ☐ Egg ☐ Caffeine ☐ Tuna ☐ Pork ☐ Nuts

Other: _____

Safe snacks I can have: _____

If I eat something unsafe, please call: _____

Thank you for keeping me safe! ♥

MY ALLERGY CARD

My name: _____

I cannot eat: ☐ Gluten (wheat) ☐ Dairy (milk) ☐ Corn ☐ Egg ☐ Caffeine ☐ Tuna ☐ Pork ☐ Nuts

Other: _____

Safe snacks I can have: _____

If I eat something unsafe, please call: _____

Thank you for keeping me safe! ♥

PRINTABLE 2

Label decoder cards

Print, cut out and keep in your purse or phone case. Read labels for these words.

Gluten

wheat, barley, rye, spelt, malt, semolina, semovita, durum, couscous, bulgur, seitan, brewer's yeast

Dairy

milk, butter, cream, cheese, whey, casein, caseinate, lactose, ghee, milk solids, buttermilk, curds

Corn

maize, cornflour, cornstarch, corn syrup, glucose syrup, dextrose, maltodextrin, xanthan gum, polenta. May come from corn: baking powder, citric acid, vanilla extract

Egg

egg, albumin, ovalbumin, lysozyme, mayonnaise, meringue, anything starting “ovo-”

Caffeine

coffee, tea, matcha, green tea, guarana, cola, cocoa, chocolate, kola nut, yerba mate, energy drinks

Processed sugar

sugar, cane sugar, sucrose, glucose, fructose, corn syrup, invert syrup, dextrose, caramel

Pork

pork, ham, bacon, lard, gelatine, pancetta, chorizo, salami, pepperoni

Nuts (school)

almond, cashew, hazelnut, walnut, pecan, pistachio, peanut, groundnut, kuli kuli

PRINTABLE 3

Smart swaps cheat sheet

Instead of...	Use...
Wheat flour	Cassava, buckwheat, tapioca or rice flour
Bread	Easy Buckwheat Bread, cassava flatbread
Pasta	Rice, lentil or chickpea pasta
Semovita, wheat swallow	Pounded yam, amala, plantain fufu
Pap / ogi / akamu	Pure millet porridge
Cow's milk	Coconut, rice or tiger nut milk
Butter	Coconut oil or olive oil
Cheese	Dairy-free cheese, nutritional yeast
Yogurt	Coconut yogurt
Egg	Flax egg (1 tbsp ground flax + 3 tbsp water)
Baking powder	Baking soda + lemon juice or vinegar
Cornflour (to thicken)	Tapioca flour
Stock cubes	Healing Seasoning Mix
Soy sauce	Coconut aminos
Tea, coffee, energy drinks	Rooibos, ginger, lemon balm, zobo
Chocolate, Milo	Carob
Sugar, sweets	Dates, ripe banana or plantain, pure maple syrup, honey (age 1+)
Tuna	Mackerel, sardines, salmon, tilapia
Pork, bacon, ham	Chicken, turkey, beef
Peanut butter (school)	Sunflower-seed butter
Deep frying	Baking, steaming, boiling
Foil	Parchment paper

PRINTABLE 4

Food & mood tracker • Days 1–15

Tick or score 1–5. After 2 weeks, look back — patterns jump out.

Day	Sleep	Mood	Tummy & poo	New food tried	Notes
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					
13					
14					
15					

PRINTABLE 5

Food & mood tracker · Days 16–30

Tick or score 1–5. After 2 weeks, look back — patterns jump out.

Day	Sleep	Mood	Tummy & poo	New food tried	Notes
16					
17					
18					
19					
20					
21					
22					
23					
24					
25					
26					
27					
28					
29					
30					

PRINTABLE 6

I tried it!

Every time your child tries a new food — even one tiny lick — they get a sticker or a star. 30 tries = a big celebration!

1 Food:	**2** Food:	**3** Food:	**4** Food:	**5** Food:
6 Food:	**7** Food:	**8** Food:	**9** Food:	**10** Food:
11 Food:	**12** Food:	**13** Food:	**14** Food:	**15** Food:
16 Food:	**17** Food:	**18** Food:	**19** Food:	**20** Food:
21 Food:	**22** Food:	**23** Food:	**24** Food:	**25** Food:
26 Food:	**27** Food:	**28** Food:	**29** Food:	**30** Food:

Every try counts! ★

PRINTABLE 7

Weekly meal planner

Plan the week, then write your shopping list on the next page.

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snack / lunch box
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

PRINTABLE 8

Lunch box planner

Plan the school week. Remember: one safe food + one new food in every box.

Day	Main	Fruit	Vegetable	Snack	Drink
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					

Prep on Sunday

New food to try this week

PRINTABLE 9

My shopping list

Vegetables

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Grains & flours

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Fruit

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Dairy-free

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Protein

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Pantry & spices

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

PRINTABLE 10

Herb & supplement log

Write down every herb or supplement, how much, and anything you notice.

Date	Herb / supplement	Amount	Time	Notes & reactions

Safety first

Start one new herb or supplement at a time, at a small amount. Always check with your child's doctor first, especially if they take medication.

PRINTABLE 11

Doctor visit notes

Fill this in before an appointment and take it with you.

Signs I've noticed (and since when)

My questions

Tests to ask about

- [ ] Ferritin & full blood count
- [ ] Iron studies
- [ ] Vitamin B12
- [ ] Thyroid (TSH ± free T4)
- [ ] Coeliac screen (tTG-IgA + total IgA)
- [ ] CRP (± ESR)
- [ ] Vitamin D
- [ ] Liver function & albumin
- [ ] Metabolic panel
- [ ] Zinc & copper
- [ ] Fasting glucose & insulin

What the doctor said · next steps

PRINTABLE 12

My child's safe foods

Write down the foods your child loves today — and the ones you're working on. Share it with anyone who cooks for them.

Safe foods — always yes

Foods we're trying

Healing Celebrations

BONUS BOOK 4

A real birthday cake, party food & a survival guide for parties, church events and eating out



13 party recipes

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free | Processed sugar-free | Nut-free

Every child deserves a slice.

BY

Tris Eliverson

WELCOME

Every child deserves a slice



Dear Mama, dear Papa,

Birthdays, owambes, Christmas, Eid, school parties — they should be full of joy. But when your child has allergies, they can be full of worry instead. Will there be anything they can eat? Will they feel left out?

This little book is my answer. A real birthday cake your child can blow candles out on. Party food the whole room will enjoy — not "special" food that looks different. And a simple plan for every party, church event and day out.

Every recipe is free from gluten, dairy, corn, eggs, caffeine, tuna, pork, processed sugar and nuts.

Every child deserves a slice. ♥

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

INSIDE THIS BOOK

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THE STAR OF THE PARTY

A real birthday cake

Every child deserves to blow out candles on a cake they can actually eat.

BIRTHDAY

Celebration Vanilla Berry Cake

1 hr + cooling · one 20 cm / 8 in cake

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup (140 g) brown rice flour
- [ ] ½ cup (60 g) tapioca flour + ½ cup (80 g) potato starch
- [ ] 1 tsp psyllium husk powder
- [ ] ½ cup pure maple syrup
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda, ¼ tsp salt
- [ ] ¾ cup coconut milk or water
- [ ] ⅓ cup light olive or avocado oil
- [ ] 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar + 1 tsp pure vanilla powder

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a round tin with parchment.
2. Whisk all the dry ingredients together.
3. Add the milk, oil, vinegar and vanilla. Mix just until smooth.
4. Bake 30–35 min until a skewer comes out clean. Cool completely.
5. Frost with chilled whipped coconut cream + 1 tbsp maple syrup. Top with berries and candles!

Why it helps: No egg, dairy, gluten, corn, nuts or processed sugar — every child at the party can have a slice.

Cupcakes: Makes 12 cupcakes too — bake 18–20 min. Many vanilla extracts use corn alcohol, so use pure vanilla powder.

Fluffy coconut frosting

- Chill 2 tins of full-fat coconut milk overnight.
- Scoop out only the thick cream on top.
- Whisk 2 min with 1 tbsp maple syrup until fluffy.
- Keep the cake in the fridge until party time.

Decorate without food colouring

- **Pink:** a spoon of beetroot juice or blended strawberries.
- **Yellow:** a pinch of turmeric.
- **Purple:** blended blueberries.
- Top with fresh berries, mango stars and coconut flakes.

Freeze slices for school birthdays — your child will always have their own cake when classmates celebrate.

PARTY Carob Birthday Cupcakes

45 min · makes 12

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 batch Celebration Cake batter (see the cake page)
- [ ] 3 tbsp carob powder (add to the dry ingredients)
- [ ] Frosting: cream from 2 chilled tins coconut milk
- [ ] 2 tbsp carob powder + 1 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] Berries or coconut flakes, to decorate

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a muffin tin with 12 cases.
2. Make the cake batter, adding the carob to the dry ingredients.
3. Fill the cases ⅔ full. Bake 18–20 min. Cool.
4. Whisk coconut cream, carob and maple until fluffy.
5. Pipe or spread on top and decorate.

Why it helps: Chocolate-style cupcakes with no cocoa, caffeine, dairy, egg or nuts.

PARTY Party Jollof Rice (serves 12)

1 hr 15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 6 cups long-grain parboiled rice
- [ ] 12 tomatoes, 6 red peppers, 2 onions, 2 scotch bonnets — blended
- [ ] 4 tbsp tomato paste, ½ cup olive oil
- [ ] 2 tsp thyme, 2 tsp pure curry powder, 4 bay leaves
- [ ] 4 tsp Healing Seasoning Mix, salt
- [ ] 6 cups chicken stock

STEPS

1. Cook the blend in a large pot 20 min until thick.
2. Fry tomato paste in the oil 3 min, add the blend and spices. Cook 10 min.
3. Add stock and washed rice. Cover tightly with parchment and a lid.
4. Cook on low 30–35 min, stirring gently once.
5. Let it rest 10 min, then fluff and serve.

Why it helps: The heart of every Naija party — made without stock cubes or MSG.

Party secret: For the smoky "party" taste, let the bottom catch very slightly at the end.

PARTY Baked Peppered Chicken

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 kg chicken pieces
- [ ] 2 tsp Healing Seasoning Mix, 1 tsp thyme, salt
- [ ] 4 red peppers, 1 scotch bonnet, 1 onion — blended
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika

STEPS

1. Season chicken and bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 35 min.
2. Cook the pepper blend in oil with paprika 10 min until thick.
3. Toss the baked chicken in the pepper sauce.
4. Return to the oven 10 min to glaze.

Why it helps: Party chicken that's baked, not deep-fried — but still saucy and delicious.

PARTY Mini Moi Moi Cups

1 hr 15 min · makes 18

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups black-eyed beans, soaked & peeled
- [ ] 2 red peppers, 1 scotch bonnet, 1 onion
- [ ] 4 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 2 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] About 1½ cups warm water
- [ ] Silicone cupcake cases

STEPS

1. Blend beans, peppers and onion with water until very smooth.
2. Stir in oil, crayfish, seasoning and salt.
3. Fill silicone cases ⅔ full and set in a steamer.
4. Steam 35–40 min until firm.
5. Cool slightly and pop out.

Why it helps: Egg-free, perfectly portioned and easy for little hands at a party.

PARTY Baked Plantain Puff-Puff Bites

30 min · makes 24

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 very ripe plantains
- [ ] 1 cup cassava flour
- [ ] ½ cup coconut milk
- [ ] ½ tsp nutmeg, pinch of salt
- [ ] ½ tsp baking soda + 1 tsp lemon juice
- [ ] Coconut oil, for the tin
- [ ] Cinnamon, for dusting

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 200 °C / 400 °F. Oil a mini muffin tin well.
2. Blend plantain and coconut milk until smooth.
3. Stir in flour, nutmeg, salt and baking soda, then the lemon juice.
4. Spoon into the tin. Bake 15–18 min until golden.
5. Dust with a little cinnamon while warm — the plantain is sweet enough.

Why it helps: Puff-puff without wheat, egg or deep frying — so your child can join the party plate.

PARTY Crunchy Cassava Chin Chin

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups cassava flour
- [ ] 3 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] ½ tsp ground nutmeg, pinch of salt
- [ ] ⅓ cup solid coconut oil
- [ ] About ⅓ cup coconut milk

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line 2 trays with parchment.
2. Mix flour, nutmeg and salt. Rub in the coconut oil with your fingers.
3. Add the maple syrup, then coconut milk a little at a time, to make a firm dough.
4. Roll out 5 mm thick and cut into small squares.
5. Bake 15–20 min, stirring once, until golden. They crisp as they cool.

Why it helps: The chin chin every Nigerian child knows — with no wheat, no egg, no processed sugar and no deep frying.

Picky eater trick: Let your child cut the squares with a blunt knife. Kids eat what they make.

PARTY Nut-Free Chicken Suya Skewers

30 min + marinating

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g chicken breast, cut into strips
- [ ] 2 tsp paprika, 1 tsp ground ginger
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic powder, 1 tsp onion powder
- [ ] ½ tsp cayenne (less for kids), 1 tsp salt
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] Sliced onion, tomato & cucumber

STEPS

1. Mix spices, salt and oil. Rub over the chicken. Rest 30 min.
2. Thread onto soaked wooden skewers.
3. Bake at 220 °C / 425 °F for 12–15 min, turning once.
4. Serve with fresh onion, tomato and cucumber.

Why it helps: Classic suya spice uses groundnut (kuli kuli). This version is nut-free and party-safe.

PARTY Rainbow Fruit Wands

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] Strawberries, pineapple, mango, kiwi, grapes, blueberries
- [ ] Watermelon slices
- [ ] Paper straws or blunt skewers
- [ ] Star cookie cutter

STEPS

1. Cut fruit into chunks, in rainbow order.
2. Cut stars from the watermelon slices.
3. Thread the fruit onto straws and top each with a star.
4. Chill until party time.

Why it helps: Children who won't touch a fruit bowl will happily eat a magic wand.

PARTY Zobo Party Punch

20 min + chilling

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup dried hibiscus (zobo) leaves
- [ ] 8 cups water
- [ ] 1 thumb ginger, sliced, 4 cloves
- [ ] ½ pineapple, peeled (keep the peel too)
- [ ] 6 dates (to sweeten)
- [ ] Orange slices, to serve

STEPS

1. Rinse the zobo. Boil with water, ginger, cloves and pineapple peel for 15 min.
2. Add the dates, turn off the heat and steep 30 min.
3. Strain well. Blend the pineapple flesh and stir it in.
4. Chill and serve with orange slices and ice.

Why it helps: Bright red, fruity and naturally caffeine-free — a party drink everyone can share.

PARTY Coconut Mango Ice Pops

No processed sugar
10 min + freezing

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 ripe mangoes, peeled & chopped
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] Juice of ½ lime
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey (optional — not for babies under 1)

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Pour into ice-pop moulds or small cups.
3. Freeze for 6 hours or overnight.
4. Run the mould under warm water for 10 seconds to pop out.

Why it helps: A sweet, cold treat with no dairy, no processed sugar and a big dose of vitamin C.

Sweet moment: Let your child pour the mix into the moulds — helping makes them want to taste.

PARTY Carob Fudge Bites

No processed sugar
15 min + chilling

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup soft pitted dates
- [ ] 3 tbsp carob powder
- [ ] 3 tbsp sunflower-seed butter
- [ ] 2 tbsp coconut oil
- [ ] Desiccated coconut, for rolling

STEPS

1. Blend dates, carob, seed butter and oil until sticky.
2. Roll into small balls.
3. Roll in coconut and chill 1 hour.

Why it helps: Tastes like chocolate fudge — no cocoa, no caffeine, no nuts.

PARTY Strawberry Coconut Cheesecake Cups

No processed sugar
20 min + chilling

YOU NEED

- [ ] Base: 1 cup dates + ½ cup sunflower seeds + ½ cup gluten-free oats
- [ ] 2 cups thick coconut yogurt
- [ ] 1 tbsp pure maple syrup
- [ ] 1 cup strawberries, chopped
- [ ] Squeeze of lemon

STEPS

1. Blitz the base ingredients and press into 6 small cups.
2. Mix yogurt, maple and lemon. Spoon on top.
3. Top with strawberries. Chill 1 hour.

Why it helps: No-bake, no dairy, no nuts — a party-worthy treat.

PLAN IT

Party menus & make-ahead plan

Three ready-made party menus. Mix and match — every dish is in this book.

Kids' birthday

- Celebration Vanilla Berry Cake
- Carob Birthday Cupcakes
- Nut-Free Chicken Suya Skewers
- Rainbow Fruit Wands
- Coconut Mango Ice Pops
- Zobo Party Punch

Naija party & owambe

- Party Jollof Rice
- Baked Peppered Chicken
- Mini Moi Moi Cups
- Baked Plantain Puff-Puff Bites
- Crunchy Cassava Chin Chin
- Zobo Party Punch

Christmas, Eid & holidays

- Party Jollof Rice
- Baked Peppered Chicken
- Suya Skewers
- Strawberry Coconut Cheesecake Cups
- Carob Fudge Bites
- Rainbow Fruit Wands

Make-ahead plan

One week before

- Bake and freeze the cake or cupcakes (un-iced).
- Make chin chin and fudge bites — store airtight.
- Make a batch of Healing Seasoning Mix.

The day before

- Steam the moi moi cups.
- Make zobo punch and chill.
- Marinate the chicken. Freeze ice pops.
- Chill coconut milk for frosting.

On the day

- Cook jollof and bake the chicken.
- Bake puff-puff bites.
- Frost the cake, make fruit wands.
- Breathe — and enjoy the party!

BE PREPARED

Party survival guide

Parties, owambes, church events and school trips can feel scary. With a little planning, your child can join in — and feel included.

Before the party

- Message the host early. Share the allergy card from the Printables pack.
- Ask what will be served — then offer to bring one safe dish to share.
- Feed your child a proper meal first, so they're never hungry and tempted.

Pack a "party box"

- A slice of the Celebration Cake, frozen ahead in portions.
- Nuggets, plantain chips, fruit kebabs, a juice from Healing Sips.
- Make it look special — a bright box, a sticker, a party napkin.

At the party

- Stay close to the food table for younger children.
- Teach a simple line: "No thank you, I have my own special snack."
- Watch for shared bowls of sweets, chin chin and puff-puff.

Eating out

- Choose grilled chicken or fish, plain rice, boiled potatoes, salad.
- Ask: "Is there wheat, milk, butter, egg or corn starch in this?"
- Avoid sauces, gravies, batters and anything deep-fried in shared oil.

Sensory overwhelm is real

Loud music and crowds can be a lot. Arrive early when it's quiet, find a calm corner, and plan a gentle exit time. Leaving happy is a win.

PRINTABLE

Letter to the party host

Print, fill in and send to the party host a few days before. Keep a copy in your bag.

Dear _____,

Thank you so much for inviting _____ to the party — we are really looking forward to it!

My child has food allergies and cannot eat: ☐ Gluten (wheat) ☐ Dairy (milk) ☐ Corn ☐ Egg ☐ Caffeine ☐ Tuna ☐ Pork ☐ Nuts ☐ Processed sugar

Other: _____

To make it easy for you, I will bring: _____

Could you please let me know what food will be served, so I can make sure my child has something similar? It means a lot that they can join in like everyone else.

If you have any questions, please call me on: _____

Thank you for helping keep my child safe and happy! ♥

From: _____

CELEBRATE

Here's to every celebration

Every candle blown out, every party joined, every “yes, you can have that” — these are the moments we heal for.

Remember

- Freeze cake slices for surprise school birthdays.
- Always pack a “party box” — just in case.
- Share the host letter and allergy card ahead of time.

The whole series

- **Healing Plates** — the 30-day family meal plan
- **Healing Lunch Box** — 30 days of school lunches
- **Healing Sips** — 30 gentle detox drinks
- **Healing Printables** — cards, trackers & planners

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

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